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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yyTdlVgmZjw
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-24. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:13:34] You know, as a fan of American Ninja Warrior, you know, I thought we would have the celebrity status here. You know, my son, of course, is a ninja warrior, and I now have a grandson who's in training. He's two years old, and he's already learned how to climb out of his crib.

[00:13:50] That's good. You've got to start young. Yep. I want to remind everybody in order for them to be able to hear us, make sure your microphone is on when you need to ask a question or talking. Her presentation will be on the screen as well, but I've also uploaded in your board book.

[00:14:07] go ahead and refresh. Okay, then we will call the meeting of the Virginia Board of Education to order. We have some very distinguished people with us today and looking forward to the presentation. I'd also like to take a minute to introduce the, I guess I can still say new superintendent of public instruction for the Commonwealth of Virginia, Jillian Balow. Welcome. I don't know if you had anything you wanted to say to start out or we can wait till tomorrow if you'd prefer for the business meeting of the board. How about if I just say thank you uh president gecker it's a pleasure to be here and um i'll always take the title of new because in this position i know from a little experience that every day feels like day number

[00:14:47] one there you go good to keep it fresh okay uh then dr darling hammond we're going to turn this over to you for your uh presentation on the impacts of teacher evaluation and professional

development on student outcomes you know i think you know it's a topic the board has been looking at potentially to study in depth and we look forward to hearing from you since you are actually more celebrity than your son sean so in our world uh well it's great to be here you know i share with

[00:15:21] you the experience of being a state board member so first i just want to start with my um appreciation for your work and my empathy uh for what you um for what you're working on i'm here with my colleague, Maria Heiler, who is the director of our DC office and is also a board certified teacher, a former teacher educator, and a researcher now on teacher development.

[00:15:53] And Maria, I'm gonna say thanks to introduce yourself beyond that. - Hello, good afternoon. I'm here in Maryland, so not so far up the road for us. I hope we've embraced some bad weather this weekend, I hear. - I'm glad to be on the left coast, as they say, where we don't have that.

[00:16:11] So I'm gonna go ahead and share my screen. I actually also have a little video clip. I'm gonna hope that that works. I'm gonna ask you some questions about what you see in the video clip when we get there about teacher effectiveness. And we'll take it from there. So let's see if my technology works properly.

[00:16:32] And are you seeing my PowerPoint? Are we good? Not yet? Okay, okay.

[00:16:54] Let me know when we've got it. that all the time emily well i'll go close my door how are we doing i think we've got it now

[00:17:24] thank you thanks emily terrific yes so i'm going to zip through this quickly you will you have copies or will have copies um and let's go back and see deep dive into anything that's of interest later i just want to be sure to give you sort of the panel play and give us a lot of time for conversation um i'm going to draw on two sources one is a book that i think you might might have gotten the first chapter of called Getting Teacher Evaluation Right.

[00:17:56] And the other is a book that was a study of high quality teacher development system in countries around the world called Empowered Educators. We looked at five nations, including Singapore, Finland, Australia, Canada, and Shanghai, China.

[00:18:13] So I draw on both of those. The teacher evaluation question is a challenging one that I know that folks have been dealing with for quite some time. There are lots of reasons for this. Historically, we've had a lack of coherent and meaningful standards.

[00:18:32] Time is an issue, expertise is an issue, linking it to professional development. Sometimes the processes are unwieldy for making decisions. And then there are challenges in figuring out how to attend to student learning. The recent history of teacher evaluation, Virginia has been a part of, as have all states.

[00:18:51] Before 2002, there was, generally speaking, little state role and systems were often quite weak. Across the country, there was the federal race to the top and the waivers that incentivized states to introduce teacher evaluation, including student test results that occurred after 2008.

[00:19:11] There has been a lot of research showing unstable results of test-based value added measures for many teachers. And I see that you are ensuring that this contribution is a modest one to your overall system now.

[00:19:26] The federal guidance was set aside when ESSA was authorized. And so many states are now currently finding their teacher evaluations. Hopefully that refinement will make systems better, but evaluation could even make matters worse.

[00:19:42] So just to frame the problems that can be out there, sometimes evaluation just becomes a set of procedures and the procedures can feel like a lot of food for people to jump through, to get through and to get the farm site, rather than focusing on competence that affects them.

[00:20:01] I'm really gonna focus us as you asked me to on what really supports teacher effectiveness in terms of their influence on student learning. It can be challenging if we get complicated systems that put all the weight on school principals or very busy people.

[00:20:18] If we design systems that can't be implemented, if we create systems that focus on ranking individual teachers against each other rather than improving the collective quality of teaching. And I wanna pause there just to note that there's been a lot of research in recent years about how collective efficacy is a huge driver of student achievement.

[00:20:38] This is the way in which teachers in a school, as a group, come to share practices and develop ways of working that are effective and that they share those so the kids are getting a coherent experience and teachers are continually collaborating to improve.

[00:20:57] So individual teacher evaluation can either work with that or can work against it. And that's an important criteria. So I'm gonna start with the end in mind, how do we help teachers become effective? An evaluation is only one piece of how we help teachers become effective, but it should fit in with the other pieces.

[00:21:17] I'm gonna show you a teacher. She's a national board certified teacher in Detroit, Michigan, science teacher, just a few minutes of her classroom. And I want you to be thinking about what you see. does get extremely uh powerful outcomes with her students what do you see that may contribute to those outcomes what are some of the elements of effectiveness and i'm going to come back and ask you about that in a minute we're scientists ourselves right we want to find out if it's true that the cellular membrane is permeable it means it makes it out right so we're going to use

[00:21:51] an egg okay we're going to use an egg you see in the classroom when i ask the students how would you get the membrane initially that a lot of them thought about the egg because they took their past experiences they boil the egg they peel it off the membranes right there but i had to understand that this is a living cell and the living cell has cytoplasm you can't do that

[00:22:30] I had the students decide how to dissolve it, and then that made them interested. If I would have just said, "Okay, today you are going to dissolve the other ribbit of an egg in vinegar," they would have said, "Okay."

[00:22:49] I would have asked them two days later, "What did you dissolve? What acid did you use?" They would say, "I don't know, whatever you told us to." now if i asked them to integrate them low enough to dissolve the membrane to dissolve the eggshell without affecting the membrane a couple of the groups woke their eggs accidentally and they thought the experiment is now a disaster but that's i want to mention that there's limitations in life the scientific word is a limitation what's the problem what what is this you're a scientist Why is it a limitation?

[00:23:29] On the membrane, on the shell, the membrane is off. Were you, okay, exactly, what is it? The membrane. All right, let's look at it. Yeah. All right, can you describe the membrane? It's rubbery.

[00:23:45] Absolutely. So, if it's rubbery, does it have pores in it? Yes. But we can't see them how smooth there are pores in it. Without a microscope, how can you prove in your scientific investigation that you can see the consistency of the member?

[00:24:05] You see, they can't see the court. They cannot see the court, but their money is traffic. Well, they read that, learned that, and some past experience that we've done because I didn't lecture to that. So that was a learning experience for them. What happened? They have to feel secure in making a mistake and not thinking it would be ridiculed by me or the other students in the classroom and they have to get us to stand it.

[00:24:43] I don't know anything and the kids can ask them something and if I don't know and I tell them I'm going to look it up, they feel more secure with me asking them questions. and then not doing it. The best thing to do is to go around and catch it, catch them while they're doing it.

[00:25:05] - For a minute. And I'm gonna ask you, what did you see that were elements of what makes her an effective teacher in that video? And I'm gonna ask someone there at the table, the chair to call on folks, 'cause I can't see you well enough to do that.

[00:25:21] - I'm happy to call on people, thanks. Mr. Swan. - I'll go. I saw relationships, I saw the teacher as the facilitator. She did less talking and allowed the students to talk more.

[00:25:39] I saw the Virginia five C's which was collaboration, creative thinking, communication, the citizenship with the respect for each other's, the peers and the critical thinking when the teacher came around as the facilitator asking those questions.

[00:25:56] I like when the teacher said how she allowed the students be secure in making mistakes um because a lot of students do not like to participate in learning and when they see that the teacher doesn't know everything it makes them more comfortable and she she um kind of alluded to that as well and so those are those are the things that i saw that made her an effective teacher great others any sitting superintendents well i was just i mean

[00:26:31] after that i mean drop the mic that was a drop the mic moment mr swan um but i guess i would add she seemed to also be aware of the experiences the children were bringing or maybe familiar to them as a part of really making the learning active and i just i thought that was notable dr robertson i saw uh proximity uh how she positioned herself in the classroom effectively i saw her creating an anticipatory set for what the lesson should uh entail saw her monitoring the

[00:27:07] the uh the work of the individual groups and i saw her recognizing success when it occurred anybody else miss holton i saw her willing to uh accept a level of uh controlled chaos it was controlled but there was chaos and she was willing to let that go on and the cacophony um of of conversation and learning what didn't upset her it was part of the plan superintendent thank you i've never used this term before but there was evidence-based confidence building

[00:27:44] she didn't just say good job she said you did this because you knew this or you knew this therefore you were able to do this and she really built the confidence of the students in in an in an individual, evidence-based way.

[00:28:02] - Yeah, I think you've exhausted us now, Doctor. - Okay, that was really good. And you know, just one or two other things that were kind of embedded in what you said, but just to draw them out. She

asked those questions that scaffolded them towards an understanding, so she was really able to enable them through her very skillful questioning.

[00:28:23] She also was doing an identity treatment for them. Did you notice how many times she said, You're a scientist, and they were taking on the identity of being scientists. You're a scientist in your scientific investigation. How could you do that? And so that was also sort of an affirming piece of their academic identity, so all those things.

[00:28:44] So when you look at your teacher evaluation system, you wanna think about to what extent the five C's that you mentioned, the other elements that you mentioned, which were right on the money, are represented in the teacher evaluation instrument.

[00:28:59] in the standards that you currently have. How are those reflected and where might there need to be or where might it be useful to have, if not additions to the standards, some additions to the indicators for the standards that reflect this kind of thing and thinking about what do effective teachers do?

[00:29:19] What does it look like? So I'm gonna go back to my PowerPoint now. You guys are excellent analysts of teaching and talk about how we get that into the system. I'm gonna ask if maybe you could mute your microphones 'cause I'm getting a lot of feedback and I'm not sure exactly where it's coming from, but when I stop, we can turn them back on again.

[00:29:42] So we'll share this again and I will get past the place where we were. Oh, I'm inadvertently adding slides. Didn't wanna do that. Here we go. So as you saw, the effective teachers, this is from the research now, They engage students in that active learning that builds on what they know.

[00:30:04] You could see that she was thinking about what they knew before. You identified that very purposeful task. It was very well-planned and that controlled chaos happened because of the good planning that had happened. A variety of teaching strategies, assessing student learning was going on throughout the whole time that create effective scaffolds and support.

[00:30:25] She was teaching a lot of academic vocabulary and academic language too. I actually learned from watching this about Cytosol and other things that I had forgotten about from whatever grade it was that I might've had that in a science class. Clear standards, a lot of feedback.

[00:30:41] What you will also see in classes is opportunities for revising work. Critically important for getting optimal achievement is giving students opportunity to get feedback and then redo or revise because that's how we get to proficiency in any field, whether it's Ninja Warrior whether it's you know music art or academics and then a collaborative classroom and all the students belong they feel affirmed in their learning you could see that happening so those are things that are coming out in the research is very important and again that you might want to look for in your

[00:31:18] standards and indicators we also know that learning is enhanced by formative assessments and well-scapled instruction that builds on prior knowledge cultural practices and experiences the right amount of challenge that you're treating a task that's in the zone or at the edge of the zone of proximal development just the right amount of challenge with the right amount of support on challenging tasks is what moves kids forward so task construction is important inquiry explicit instruction connected it's not one it's not the other it's a combination of both reducing stereotype

[00:31:54] threat stereotype throws what students in minoritized groups that may be stigmatized in society bring with them as an anxiety into the classroom will i be viewed as competent will i be accepted will i belong that can be a function of race or ethnicity it can be immigration status language background it can be sexual orientation it can be gender it can be disability status and so you reduce stereotype threat by affirming students, showing that you can see them and their

[00:32:29] capacity, and then of course teaching to that capacity, and then supporting that growth mindset, which turns out to be a huge engine for learning. What this means for educator development, both pre-service and in-service, and the way it gets connected to an evaluation system, is that it should emphasize both learner pedagogy that is knowing about your learners and how they learn and content pedagogy knowing about your subject and how to teach it well and in an evaluation system capturing both learner pedagogy and content pedagogy is a sort of an

[00:33:07] art form and i'll talk more about the both the ways we do that the ways we develop it maria will talk more about that in a little bit and also how you can structure the system to access knowledge from evaluators so that includes kind of knowing how kids develop and learn the practices that support integrated social emotional and cognitive development we know now from neuroscience and all of the other learning and developments that social and emotional cognitive development go together one is not a distraction from the other if we feel positively about an environment

[00:33:44] if we're socially adept if we're tuned into others we can collaborate effectively we can learn more effectively if we're anxious if we're traumatized if we feel uh unwelcome if we're worried about what's going to happen to us it actually puts a great deal of uh filter between the content and the brain and makes it much more difficult much more difficult to learn knowledge of how to recognize and address trauma and stereotype throat as i've said engage in restorative practices that bind kids more fully to the community

[00:34:19] and enable them to be able to sort of be who they are and say what they need to say in the right setting cultural knowledge and competence wide repertoire of skills and resources for scaffolding including universal design for learning which is becoming more and more important in multi-tier systems of support and typically is not in many evaluation systems and the development of those practices for deeper learning that you mentioned earlier. So investments in teachers' knowledge matter a lot. I'll just sort of stipulate to that. There's been large-scale research in multiple

[00:34:57] states that have found that student learning gains are related to having a strong academic background, quality preparation prior to entry, including a comprehensive preparation that includes thoughtful clinical experiences, and knowledge of learning development, teaching methods, curriculum, certification of the field experience, and the skills measured by national board certification. In North Carolina, they found that in combination, these skills predicted more of the difference in student learning gains than race and parent education combined. That's a huge,

[00:35:32] you know, thing to consider. And so our policies should strengthen those features and also equalize their availability across different classrooms, schools, and communities. To get to teacher effectiveness we need a coherent system and what which what we do in recruitment and preparation and induction and mentoring and ongoing professional learning and evaluation and curriculum all go together and that's what we see in the highest performing systems around the world in those systems in high achieving nations you see strong universal free preparation with extensive training

[00:36:10] in model schools typically in master's degree programs now in places like singapore and finland and australia and canada quality mentoring for every beginner competitive and equitable salaries obviously that's important for retention in most of these countries they have at least 15 hours a week for collaborative planning and learning in the united states that we typically have only about eight hours a week for any kind of planning and it's usually individual and there's about an additional eight hour a week gap between us and the average internationally.

[00:36:46] They have sustained and practice-based collegial learning opportunities and teaching careers and actually career ladders that help people become mentor teachers, senior teachers, master teachers in every school available then to mentor the next generation of teachers and share their expertise. There's a lot of networking for sharing practices across schools and proactive recruitment and development of leaders and i'll just note that states like connecticut illinois and north carolina all have very important elements of what they do with

[00:37:20] teacher evaluation that has to do with principal development principal recruitment training principal evaluation which rests on in part on how well principals can do the things that teachers need to become effective so those should be maybe thought about together and you may want to be thinking about your principal evaluation systems and principal development systems as you're thinking about the teacher evaluation the other point i want to make is that uh what we think about teachers as being very important to uh you know student learning and they are teaching

[00:37:55] effectiveness uh is goes beyond individual teacher uh variables so the economists who've estimated what proportion of student achievement can be attributed to individual teachers is only about 7 to 10 percent the other things that matter include the effectiveness of peers teams of teachers collaborating and planning curriculum together are more effective and drive greater effectiveness in a school than individual teachers working alone student availability for learning you know their attendance health home context all the things that might be that might require other student

[00:38:34] supports uh particularly as we see growing poverty homelessness as we see the effects of the pandemic so those integrated supports actually boost student achievement in schools because teachers then have that to rely on for their students as well as their own efforts and then of course resources for learning matter curriculum class size specialist supports and so on so we can't put it all on the individual teacher but we can create an environment in which individual teachers can be more effective in a collaborative workplace working with a team having high quality curriculum

[00:39:13] materials by the way teachers are more effective if they loop with their same students over more than one year and they're more effective if they teach the same course in secondary school for more than one year that is when teachers are asked to jump around from grade to grade or course to course, it reduces their effectiveness. And all of these elements depend on school leaders. So one of the things that we need to do to improve teacher effectiveness is to focus on principal effectiveness. And so principal training and evaluation should support teacher evaluation

[00:39:47] and development, which includes well-informed instructional leadership, support for professional learning and collaboration, thoughtful development of the organization, skillful management of improvement uh as well as knowledgeable analysis of teaching and productive feedback to teachers there was one uh study of principal development that we just reviewed in a research literature review in

which the the principals who knew how to look at teaching understand what they saw give useful feedback to teachers a drill greater effectiveness in their schools and the principals

[00:40:25] who were giving more feedback to teachers because they had an evaluation expectation but didn't know how to do it well actually produced a negative effect so a lot of times we think about let's train the principals to use the teacher evaluation tool but there's a lot more that needs to be done in training principals for the work they do in the in the school as well as to evaluate teachers and that ought to be reflected in their on-ramp into the profession and their training and their

[00:40:59] own evaluation. So how can teacher evaluation help support effectiveness directly? One thing is to use professional standards coherently. There are a set of standards, a lot of these came from the National Board for Professional Teaching Standards back in the 1990s and then those got translated into licensure standards Virginia is also by the way a member of a teacher licensure collaborative that LPI is supporting for multiple states that are looking on how about at how to bring their licensure standards um up into the sort of uh 21st century science of learning and

[00:41:39] development um and many of the features that you all noticed in that video are the subject of that work, but your standards for evaluation ought to track to your standards for preparation and accreditation of teacher and principal preparation programs, licensure and certification assessments, professional practice and evaluation, and mentoring and professional development. Ideally, that is all glued together so that teachers and principals are getting a set of common measures. Your current evaluation standards are comprehensive in many ways and have just added culturally responsive

[00:42:18] teaching and equitable practices which is responsive to the emerging knowledge base but they are not yet glued to all of those other things for example um there are new things that have come about since the evaluation system was designed including the profile of a virginia educator which is very thoughtful and it really looks like it builds on a lot of the research um it is not uh glued to the teacher evaluation standards yet and one and and perhaps not also to the licensure and other standards that i talked about so that's a thing to consider how to make

[00:42:57] it coherent um the teaching the teaching career can also be made more coherent by thinking about tiers of licensure and evaluation assessment in new mexico they have evaluation in a three-tiered system which includes the beginning teacher licensure assessment around the standards that then are re-evaluated in the professional license assessment and in ongoing teacher evaluation and then may lead to more advanced and accomplished assessment and roles through national board

[00:43:36] certification. Another thing to think about is how to integrate the sources of evidence with each other many evaluation systems and i think this is true of virginia's um have different pieces and they're tallied up and then averaged together with some kind of weighting system but it is important if we want to help teachers improve that part of the process actually look at the standards-based measures of practice which you have in the system along with the evidence of collegial contributions measures of student learning and growth linked by teachers goals

[00:44:13] for how they want to develop and considered in their context so that teachers and principals are able to make sense of how these things come together into a teacher's practice. I will note that there's very little emphasis in the current Virginia system on evidence of collegial contributions. There is a place where there's a bullet for that, but I'm going to talk about other ways that emphasizing and supporting collegiality and collaboration could be thought

[00:44:47] about because it is such a driver for greater effectiveness. Obviously, you're also using multiple measures to reflect practice, including the standards-based observations and curriculum plans and evidence of practices to support certain student learning and feedback surveys, etc. So you've got a variety of those. Thinking about whether they are tapping what you want is part of the process as well. And then using multiple measures to assess student learning.

[00:45:19] In the current system in Virginia, there are a number of test data elements, including division level data on diagnostics like math and so on and other indicators that are academic assessments.

[00:45:41] There are systems that as well use classroom assessments, pre and post unit tests, essays, research projects, etc. as part of that basket of evidence that may use things like if you're an AP teacher may use the AP test scores if you're an international baccalaureate teacher they may use the international baccalaureate scores if you're an elementary teacher you might use the developmental reading assessment which allows you to see student gains over time or accomplishment of learner goals so it struck me that that's a place to think about how to reflect best what that teacher is

[00:46:20] responsible for in ways that will allow them to demonstrate what they're focusing on in student learning and what their outcomes are. There are many systems that are goal-setting systems where teachers each year set particular goals for themselves and then set particular measures that they'd like to evaluate themselves on. So for example, I want to improve my teaching of quadratic equations and I'm going to you know decide on having a pre-assessment of that unit

[00:46:58] and a post-assessment and I'm going to do these things to improve my knowledge and skill for that and then evaluate them in that way so adding that opportunity for teachers to map that to their particular curriculum to what they themselves are trying to accomplish could be very helpful and then I mentioned the collaboration piece collaboration is related to teachers sense of efficacy whether they use more sophisticated practices their effectiveness it is a predictor

[00:47:32] of student achievement gains and it can be enhanced by teacher evaluation practices in some countries like the ones that I talked about earlier collaboration is a major criterion for evaluation it's not a single bullet under professionalism it is a an element of in and of itself and it is something therefore that teachers are striving to of course the school has to structure means for that collaboration as well it can be a process in an evaluation system by which teachers set goals and plan strategies and assess their progress together in the book i mentioned

[00:48:11] getting teacher evaluation right you'll see some examples of states that have and districts that have processes by which collaborative processes by which teachers do their evaluation goal setting and decide on what their measures of student learning will be and help each other think about ways to improve practice and assess their progress together there are some places too where teachers can in the years where they are you know the requirement is that every third year you have a formal individual evaluation there are some places including santa clara a school district

[00:48:49] right up the street from where i live where teachers can do their evaluation as a team and set goals together and i saw one example where a couple of teachers decided they wanted to improve writing in the content areas they set some goals they decided on some professional development they work with each other to do some new practices they saw huge effects of those they talked to their department about it the whole department started to do it pretty soon the whole school had a new writing program which came from a teacher evaluation starting place but grew into

[00:49:28] an effectiveness strategy that went beyond those a couple of teachers teachers can give each other feedback around their their goals at the end in some schools you have reciprocal observations where teachers are trained to give each other feedback and teachers can ask for their partner to look at certain things that they're doing in the classroom and get feedback and so the other thing is that student learning evidence can be used to promote that collaboration by analyzing

[00:50:02] the work that students do in teams by setting school-wide subject level, grade level, team-based goals. You can see how educators can factor in a focus on student learning in a collaborative way that also informs the teacher evaluation process. I would just note that the U.S. has less collaboration time for teachers than almost any other country. We have more hours spent on teaching each week and year in the united states than any other country that participates in oecd

[00:50:37] studies in the world and we're at the very bottom in terms of collaborative planning and time and that will take some redesign there's about an eight hour differential in access to time for american teachers versus the international average there are ways to to do that redesign some schools have done it it is um you know something that is important as an adjunct to evaluation because if we're evaluating people on things that they don't have the opportunity to get to learn to do where evaluation is a set of hoops but it's not actually a lever for effectiveness

[00:51:15] obviously we also want to develop effective processes um i mentioned the training uh of principals for teacher evaluation and support but we can also include principals ability to do that in their own evaluation. We can also use expert teachers to support beginning teachers and coaching peers in need. I don't know if in Virginia there are peer assistance and review systems, but what they do in the places where they are operating is they help the principal by identifying a set of mentor teachers and as part of the evaluation process it's usually a committee,

[00:51:54] usually members of the teachers association as well as the administration that oversees that the peer assistance and review process every beginning teacher gets a mentor in their content area or grade level and that mentor is actually by contract able to input into the evaluation a process for the beginning teacher and give them more help than a principal can often find time to give and then if there are teachers who are in need who are struggling they can be

[00:52:28] opted into the intervention part of the process by themselves recommended in by peers or recommended in by the principal and once they're in that support system part of the process they get a mentor also who meets with them every week and then contributes to a record of what the improvement has been that can be used in tenure and continuation cases and it ends up eliminating litigation it provides the due process and it structures the collegial work

[00:53:08] that teachers do and that they get help to do it helps the principal have an extra set of eyes and ears and arms and legs for the really intensive work that some teachers need the other thing that an effective process can do is structure collegial work around goals for teachers in the off years that could be a time when teachers are working with each other around their goal setting and process and the principal does not have to be involved unless they are in a category of teachers that needs additional support help and evaluation right now virginia school leaders in most districts seem to carry the whole load they are the sole evaluators and

[00:53:47] their um that kind of varies based on school division what kind of training is going on for for them and they don't have necessarily access to senior accomplished teachers to support some of that the

current system i'm told is more summative than formative as it's implemented it does not yet have a clear system of support for novices there's a broad variation in the quality of feedback from observations a little connection between evaluation and professional

[00:54:23] development and so and i'm going to jump ahead for one second here to why i was leaving for the end there's a new report that you may have seen that just came out of virginia teacher licensure policy from virginia commonwealth university but they do mention in their review of the teacher evaluation system and the extent to which it supports teacher diversity that there are some concerns about potential bias in teacher evaluations and supervision requirements and a desire for more clarity more clear indicators to address that more trading and then a more

[00:55:02] comprehensive beginning teacher induction model as well as support for national board certified teachers so i'm going to pass the ball to maria who's going to talk a little bit about how do you connect evaluation to high quality professional learning obviously one way that can be done is through the goal setting process that i described earlier that teachers could engage in to identify what kind of professional learning they're going to use to achieve their goals can also happen as a result of evaluation so maria i'm going to pass the ball to you thank you linda

[00:55:39] um and so you know are you seeing my the right slides for me um not yet it went back so just if you click on there you go there you go yes so if we're thinking about the um the desire to connect evaluation to high quality professional learning we can do that through goal setting and purposeful learning and so what that looks like is a focus on specific curriculum content um so when you're thinking about uh what an english teacher needs it's different than what a high elementary literacy

[00:56:18] expert might need as well it needs to be organized around real problems of practice that teachers are facing in the classroom dilemmas with students the work they're doing with their children and students and the types of learning opportunities they're building and they're collaborating with their peers with it needs to be linked linked to analysis of teaching and student learning intensive sustained and continuous over time so not just popping in every now and then to look at a teacher but really over time it needs to be supported by coaching modeling observation and

[00:56:55] feedback an iterative process connected to teachers collaborative work with professional learning communities and integrated into school and classroom planning around curriculum instruction and assessment and as you can see these are linked back to everything that linda was talking about around effective teachers and environments around effective teaching and learning so traditionally when we think about professional development it's been lecture based in what we might call fit and get or drive by learning and it offers the same content and strategies to all

[00:57:30] teachers regardless of their skills and experiences and has largely been divorced from teachers day-to-day practices in their classrooms we're excited that rigorous research indicates that professional development uh programs with an impact on student learning follow a different model defined by seven core elements and we did a study that identified these seven elements um i'll just take a second to go through them uh a focus on content so the actual content that teachers teach in their classroom and i'll speak to this a little bit um in a in a moment

[00:58:07] and active learning so professional development that offers teachers a chance to meaningfully engage with new concepts and teaching strategies by actually doing them and if we think about about

what students need to learn and thrive. Teachers need the same types of activities and learning opportunities that students need.

[00:58:27] If a lecture is not going to give you the same benefit as sitting and actually doing a science lab that they're going to then take into a classroom and use with their students. Collaboration, this can look like one-on-one coaching, small groups, professional learning communities, and it can be, as we now know more directly, It can be either in-person or virtual using technology.

[00:58:52] This is often occurring in job-embedded context when teachers can plan together, offer each other feedback and problem solve about their specific students. Models and modeling. It's important to provide teachers with models of effective teaching.

[00:59:08] So there's a clear vision of what best practice looks like. This could be curricular resources like lesson and unit plans, student work or teaching courses, and it can be observations of peers or master teachers. Coaching, we know that effective coaching is necessary for professional development because it's tailored specific advice and counsel to the needs of individual teachers rather than giving a one-size-fits-all experience.

[00:59:36] And then of course, feedback and reflection is necessary to give teachers the opportunity of powerful learning moments regardless of the format. So it could be teachers offering that feedback and reflections together or individually.

[00:59:54] And it helps the teacher move towards an expert vision of articulate, expert vision of practice. And then finally, effective professional development requires a sustained amount of time. And you can go ahead to the next slide, Linda, because one study in 2007 with a review of an experimental study found that student achievement increased by 21 percentile points among programs offered extended PD, which is 49 hours on average over six to 12 months.

[01:00:28] And so it's important to see that the 49 hours were over six to 12 months. So it really needs to increase student achievement, a sustained duration of a significant amount of time. These one-off workshops just don't work for high quality professional learning.

[01:00:46] And then when we think about what increases effectiveness and what that professional development looks like in practice. We think about learning opportunities focused on practice like national board certification where individuals are going through the process or there's actually cohorts school-wide that improve the practice and the culture of the whole school.

[01:01:08] And there are 25 national board certification actual levels and a certificate by a subject matter. So it's very specific to grade level and also content level.

[01:01:25] Also, teachers need access to mentoring and coaching from accomplished teachers. As was mentioned before, it's an element of effective PD. Effective time with teams and the opportunity to work collaboratively. And we know that is a challenge as Linda just showed the research on how little time is built into the actual school day for teachers to work together.

[01:01:46] And that's important for the increasing effectiveness. And then we also need to think about focused opportunities to enhance expertise through content networks and collegial professional development, such as the National Writing Project, content networks such as the National Council for Teachers of Mathematics, or the National Council of Teachers of English.

[01:02:12] A focus on developing content knowledge is really important and some strategies to do that include what I just mentioned, content and level specific mentoring, So, an elementary teacher matched with an elementary coach.

[01:02:28] A physics teacher matched with a physics coach. Because we know the knowledge and skills for each of those are different. And so, we want to make sure that the mentoring is specific to both the content and the level. Participation in curriculum planning with role-like teachers.

[01:02:43] So, this could be grade specific or it could be all the English teachers 9th through 12th coming together to talk about curriculum across the spectrum. but really the opportunity to support one another in their planning and to help develop the skills across small cohorts of content-specific teachers.

[01:03:04] Again, the content-specific teaching networks that I just mentioned, National Board Certification is an excellent way. I haven't gone through it myself. It's not just an assessment. It actually is a learning opportunity. And many districts have cohorts of teachers that go through the process together that help to talk about your work and think about your work and then develop your practice into accomplished teaching.

[01:03:30] And then the Instructional Leadership Court is an example. In California, the ILC was formed to support implementation of new standards. Board-certified teachers as well as other accomplished teachers and leaders formed teams that learned together. It was a trainer of trainers model.

[01:03:47] So these folks came together and they learned about the new standards and ways to implement them. And then they went back to their district. to support the shifts in pedagogy, and were there over time to continue to support teachers as they learned the new standards and learned how to implement them into their daily practice.

[01:04:06] Not only is it important to develop content pedagogy, but also learner pedagogy. So teachers need to know and understand how students learn. And some ways that that can happen is through National Board Certification. Each certification has up to 16 standards, at least one to three of them focus on learning. So that's an excellent way to understand learners and learning. Authentic assessments of learning such as project-based learning or formative assessment where teachers can understand how individual and groups of students learn and then use that learning to

[01:04:41] modify their teaching. The use of tools for two-way pedagogy such as classroom meetings, one-on-one, conferencing, journaling, exit tickets, surveys to help understand where misconceptions are where there might need some modification of instruction team discussion of students to share needs and strategies again that collaboration time is so important to teaching and learning in the classroom and it's not just the classroom learning but teachers need to know and understand students lives and the learning and the critical thinking that happens in their daily

[01:05:18] lives so gaudy community walkthroughs home visits parent family conferences with protocols for partnering can be some ways of developing that learner pedagogy and then there's also explicit pedagogical study in professional learning such as Zaretta Hammond outlines in her culturally responsive teaching in the brain where she shares how to understand and connect cultural knowledge and understanding to learning in the classroom. I'm going to go ahead and pass that back to you Linda so you can summarize what was just said and we can take some questions. Yeah and those things

[01:05:52] that Maria just mentioned can be the things that would be suggested to a teacher who's trying to improve in an area as opportunities for professional learning. So you notice that some of them are explicit professional development and some are activities and processes that are part of what one might do in a school that could be part of a goal-setting process part of a commitment to develop skills or as part of a quote-unquote prescription from the evaluator saying one of the things we'd like you to do is

[01:06:28] to engage in X Y or Z just to close well if we really care about effectiveness rather than just getting through the procedures we need to be thinking about preparation and mentoring that could be actually enhanced for beginners in the the teacher evaluation system, the teaching conditions, the collegial learning opportunities, and then the systems that are coherent in their standards linked to the professional development and coaching.

[01:06:57] A rigorous of tenure and other key junctures like the peer assistance and review processes. It allows a real dive before you give tenure with serious evaluation from more than one evaluator. And it allows a dive at a point where a teacher may be struggling.

[01:07:15] uh for you know that attention or in a tiered system at key junctures and then finally designed to provide that assistance and due process and timely decisions as well as having you know well thought through forms so with that i'm going to stop uh and we can talk about whatever's on your mind well thank you very much to both of you for the incredibly informative presentation i'm sure members of the board have got some questions and uh no i do but we'll start again with mr swan

[01:07:50] thank you so much for the presentation it was very informative um i am a current classroom instructional coach and as a teacher i saw that you constantly use the national board certification how do you encourage teachers to pursue national national board certification especially if they have struggled to become a certified teacher in the very beginning such as having to take the praxis in my instance three times in the instance of some of my colleagues 15 times

[01:08:29] as well as taking the school leadership exam the lack of money to do all of the those things how would you encourage those teachers who are totally discouraged with getting any more certification due to the fact of struggling to be certified initially? Yeah, one of the things I'm just going to give you my both research-based and personal view on that. I think we should be moving away from sit-down tests that are only marginally related to the ability to teach to performance

[01:09:06] assessment. So in California in 1998, the legislature required us to use for licensure, the teacher performance assessment. So the university has created one called the performance assessment for California teachers. It's a portfolio that was modeled after the national board portfolio in which teachers have to, you know, plan a unit of instruction that, a short unit of instruction that is mapped to the state standards in their content area.

[01:09:35] It is content-based, so it's a different instrument for each content area. Teach that, we videotape teaching it, collect evidence of student learning, evaluate that evidence and say what they would do next to promote more student learning.

[01:09:53] It's very transformative for teacher education because all of a sudden, teacher education had to pay attention to the ability to pull all the skills together and be coherent and help people learn how to assess. We, of course, had elements in there that also were around meeting the needs of particular kinds

of students, students with disabilities, students who are English learners, a portion of students in California.

[01:10:17] That kind of assessment is a very different thing. And it actually drives learning. It drives greater effectiveness. There's some evidence of that from several studies. And if you have that kind of thing as the gateway to licensure, first of all, it prepares you then to be ready to become a National Board Certified Teacher because you're doing very similar processes.

[01:10:39] But it also develops a student learning orientation because you're always thinking about why did I make these decisions for this planning? Of course, you also give your planning decisions as part of it. And then what did I see about who learned what and what I would do next?

[01:10:56] And that's the orientation to effectiveness that we want all to do step. I don't think you get that by sitting down and taking a multiple choice test. And so I think that that's a move for the profession to begin to make. The thing I showed in New Mexico is really based on that.

[01:11:13] A lot of states are moving away from a single way to demonstrate basic skills or content knowledge to saying you could do that through coursework that demonstrates that you've got that knowledge where you've succeeded at some level and then focusing on practice.

[01:11:30] And I think it's just important to do that. And it's also possible for states to give incentives for people to participate in things like board certification, which does promote greater effectiveness, both individually or as groups. Some schools are using that with their state, with their SIG money from the federal government, which is for school improvement.

[01:11:52] If you have schools that are identified for improvement, are using some of those resources to help teachers together as a team, engage in those kinds of practices. - And I would just like to add as well, National board certification, just increasing the teacher's knowledge of that and what the process is like and how Linda just described it is important because national board certification is actually by teachers for teachers.

[01:12:22] So teachers themselves are fit on the board and sit on the standards committees and on actually help to develop the process. And so it is by the profession for the profession. And a practical way is just to have some board-certified teachers speak at faculty meetings and share their experiences because I think just understanding how powerful it is to be able to think about your teaching and especially in cohorts, lots of districts have cohorts that go through together.

[01:12:54] It's really powerful and it's an experience that board-certified teachers like to speak about. And then of course, the incentives for me, there was a district incentive that paid part of my national board certification. So there's the incentive of professionalizing and improving my practice, but also the financial incentive as well, and also moving along on the salary scale and schedule as part of the incentives as well.

[01:13:21] - Thank you. - We mentioned it because it has such powerful standards that are much more elaborate and content rich, as well as learner focus, than he typically will otherwise find in evaluation systems.

[01:13:40] - Dr. Wilson. - Dr. Darlingham, thank you very much for the, and Dr. Heider for your presentation. I'm struck by this idea of system and the connection that you made to teacher preparation

programs, the day-to-day support of principals and building leaders to teachers in the classroom, which then ultimately we lead to evaluation.

[01:14:09] It's like the cyclical process, perhaps after teacher preparation, although PD could probably be lumped into that. But I wonder if, and of course we're focused for our purposes right now on teacher evaluation, but it strikes me that we can't, you can't necessarily talk about one without talking about the other.

[01:14:30] And, you know, kind of where do you jump into that cycle so that ultimately we are affecting student achievement, you know, I guess as quickly as we can, we know it's a marathon, not a sprint, but my goodness, it's just, I wonder where you jump in and how we marry all of those other pieces together in a way that is meaningful, purposeful, and ultimately leading to student achievement gains as quickly and effectively as we can.

[01:15:05] - Yeah, when Connecticut first did its major reforms of teaching back in the 80s, which drove them to number one status in achievement in the country within a decade, they did principal evaluation and teacher evaluation at the same time.

[01:15:23] They developed a principal evaluation system, which was heavily dependent on principal's evaluations, principal's abilities to understand teaching and how to look at it and how to support it and how to enable it. And then they did the teacher evaluation thing at the same time.

[01:15:40] They put in place a portfolio for beginning teachers, which was part of their way of being assessed and trained people for that. But they thought about all of that together. And I think this might be an opportunity for you to think about those pieces together.

[01:15:55] The other thing they did was transform the licensure system. They looked at the standards for licensure and the standards for evaluation together. And you have that opportunity too, because Virginia is part of the teacher licensure collaborative that's looking at that question.

[01:16:11] So you could make some, I mean, you can't do everything at once. And I know that's always a challenge for all of us because our systems tend to grow up in kind of, there's like a geological dig of policies that we have to unpack.

[01:16:27] But I will say as board chair in California, I've been working on that for the last, previously with the teacher credentialing commission, a decade of lining these things up and it does make a difference. If you start, figure out where you can start given what's on your plate right now, but keep that in mind in everything that you're able to work on over the coming years, you will get to the place.

[01:16:53] We also put in place, by the way, not only the teacher performance assessments for beginning teacher licensure, but administrator performance assessments, which are now in place for administrator licensure, which require principals to learn in their preparation and to demonstrate as they get the license that they can look at teaching, understand it and evaluate it thoughtfully and come up with approaches to support teachers in their growth and learning, which then has forced the principal preparation programs to focus on that and other things as part of what they do that was borrowed from Connecticut

[01:17:31] and Massachusetts and other states that are kind of moving in those directions. So I am empathetic to the challenge and just put your bucket down with what's in front of you and keep it in mind as you have the opportunity.

[01:17:51] - Dr. Mann. - Thanks so much for the presentation. I wanna piggyback on something Mr. Swan asked and just get your perspective on the Praxis performance assessment for teachers, which is intended to be more performance-based.

[01:18:07] I wondered if you had any perspective on the evolution of that work vis-a-vis what we were speaking about around more performance-based approaches to assessment? - You know, I think it's a reasonable starting place that the PPAT, as it is fondly known, actually started in California as well.

[01:18:27] It was, ETS did our first version of a, or actually it might've been NES that did the first version, but it is very similar to the PPAT, where it's a set of tasks that teachers engage in while they're being prepared.

[01:18:43] And it does focus on the right kinds of things. It's a little less holistic than the performance assessments that I described that we have developed and we've now got a new iteration in California that goes even further to integrate all the elements of how you learn to teach, that you have to plan around your students the content you have to teach it you have to look at student learning and it's tied together but the pizza has those pieces in small parts and it's a good start towards a more performance-based system

[01:19:28] thank you very much for your presentation i really what really resonated with me is the constant reminder we need to have that evaluation is really a process and not those single events that are procedural events with tasks so in your presentation you correctly noted that here in in Virginia, much of our evaluations, if not all, rely heavily on principals and assistant principals to enact that. What are some immediate thoughts that you have for us, whether it's references to other best practices and models out there? How do we shift that culture quickly through what we can do as a state board to help shift, again, from individual going in,

[01:20:06] evaluating, and then coming back in the next time and the next time? What are some structural, procedural, immediate things that you could recommend that would benefit us as we try and change that focus and that culture? If you can think about ways to encourage, and I know there's always, you know, financial concerns, and I'm clearly aware that state boards don't control the purse strings. So you'd have to think about how to bring this together. But if there is a way to get to a mentoring system where districts can identify expert teachers and content areas who

[01:20:43] who will participate in the support for beginning teachers, that will take some of the big load off of principals, particularly in schools where you have a churn and you have a lot of beginning teachers coming in. And we know that typically teacher experience and often teacher qualifications differ across communities that students have different levels of money.

[01:21:08] And so being able to get some focus on getting expert teachers in the schools where the beginning teachers are mostly found and supporting them and mentoring them will take a lot of load off the principal who is otherwise expected to not only evaluate teachers, but be the source of learning for teachers and help them improve and it's just too much.

[01:21:35] If collective bargaining allows and if your system can accommodate it in the peer assistance and review context, quite often those teachers are enabled to be part of the data system, the evaluation information system for those candidates.

[01:21:53] And then the other one is when you have teachers who are struggling. That, you know, it's one thing for principals to, you know, see my practice and give me some feedback. If I'm doing reasonably well

and I'm setting my goals and I've got a collaborative opportunity to work with other teachers around my goals.

[01:22:12] It's another thing if I'm really struggling. And again, the principal needs help to help me and having mentor teachers in place for that is also critically important who can come in then and be an additional resource.

[01:22:29] That's a really important place to begin. The other thing, of course, is that no principal can know all of the content that you need in a high school. I lacked when I was doing work on teacher evaluation years ago, there was in one session I was doing in New York state, One teacher raised her and she said, I always get good evaluations from the French teachers.

[01:22:47] She said, when the principal comes into the room, I tell the students in French, if you know the answer, raise your right hand. If you don't know the answer, raise your left hand. And all the kids are raising their hands and I'm asking questions and everybody I call on knows the answer and I get a good evaluation.

[01:23:02] And you know, it is important. It's very hard to do content-based evaluation every year for every purpose, but it is important to do it sometimes. And those are at those key junctures for tenure and later.

[01:23:20] And if we make evaluation for tenure supportive and real, and we don't give tenure to teachers who shouldn't get it, but we are supporting them with mentoring, then the rest of the evaluation system becomes easier too, because you are only then dealing with folks who are competent and you're helping them improve.

[01:23:40] And that takes some of the burden off. I like the fact that Virginia only requires a formal evaluation every three years once the teacher has become tenured and has met an effectiveness bar, because that means the principal can spend time, you know, it doesn't have everybody in the school to work with every year because it's just overwhelming.

[01:24:04] And then, you know, I didn't get a chance to look at every part of your evaluation handbook. It's very long and has a lot of pieces. I did look at it, but it did feel like there are a lot of elements of process. And you might think about whether you can prune any of those, whether principals who are good at supporting teacher effectiveness could give advice about ways to make it as efficient for them as possible.

[01:24:33] - Thank you. And one follow-up, I really appreciated your reference to the need to have development of cultural knowledge and competence for teachers and your acknowledgement work we've done here on this board where we approve cultural responsive teaching and equitable practices as part of our evaluation standards i would just like to hear if you have any other comments of other best practice states or where you're seeing that movement move forward in a way that's benefiting students uh what have you seen in that area i think a lot of states are looking at this right now and some have put it in i have put in some standards like that and um you know

[01:25:09] helping figure out what the professional learning is around that and what you look at in the evaluation. So when we looked at Mary Edmund's class in science, I would say that she demonstrated a lot of the elements of culturally responsive practice because she was attuned to her students, she was affirming to them, she knew them. I don't know what she did before that video to get there but we have to

begin to capture some of that learner pedagogy in in the evaluation process to enable people and then think about what the learning opportunities will be and give

[01:25:48] principals and superintendents some help in thinking about how to develop those some of it may be explicit professional development and some of it may be those other two-way pedagogies that a lot of people you know struggle with culturally responsive pedagogical language and they think that it means that you have to like learn things about different cultures that sometimes can come out in stereotypic ways like okay now i've got to learn about you know this culture or that culture and then that can lead to thinking that every child who comes from that particular background

[01:26:22] has a particular set of practices which they may or may not have so you want to learn about the community you want to understand the parents you want to give people opportunities to be thoughtful about their learners and to be learner-centered and to be affirming and to minimize stereotypes threatened the things I talked about, but not to get into a simplistic approach to it.

[01:26:45] Thank you very much. Appreciate it. Well, I'll just chime in with the thanks, Dr. Darling-Hammond and Dr. Heller. As always, you all are just hugely helpful in putting us in the big perspective in the systems approach.

[01:27:05] One piece, I have a question on talking about mentoring. That is something that we have recommended, put in our standards, but don't yet have funded. Let's just put it that way in any significant way.

[01:27:21] And I guess my question to you is, can one do effective mentoring systems without financial resources, or in other words, do you have to have either full-time mentors or teachers who are compensated in a significant degree for their mentoring time, or can effective mentoring systems work without more money or without significant more money, if that's a fair question.

[01:27:46] - Well, people do it in a variety of ways. It does take some resources because you either have to free up the time for the mentors. Like if you're in a middle or a high school, you could free up part of a teacher's time to mentor another teacher, but they do need some time to do that.

[01:28:05] And some of that time needs to be when the teacher can go into the other teacher's classroom and give them some advice. So some of it can be part-time. Sometimes people also will have a teacher on mentor status for a few years and they'll serve 10 teachers or 12 teachers and they're paying for that salary of that mentor teacher.

[01:28:32] So there's going to be some resources at least in terms of time and scheduling that has to happen at least for the release time. And then of course, in some systems, that mentors are paid more because they are accomplished and using that, it may be actually time on top of the time that they're also spending teaching.

[01:28:50] So all of those are considerations. The cost that, and one of the ways that we talked to districts about this is that if you have a teacher leave, and by the way, a teacher who gets good mentoring is twice as likely to stay as a teacher who does not get mentoring.

[01:29:07] And if you have to replace that teacher, it's gonna cost you usually about $20,000 to replace the teachers. And people are desperate right now with teacher shortages being what they are to keep the teachers that they have. So they can think about it as something that, if you do it well, it pays for itself

because you're not having to spend money you would otherwise spend just to manage the churn that you otherwise get.

[01:29:34] But it is something that does require some kind of resources and people have to figure out ways to find those. Now, I'm seeing a lot of people doing this, training of mentors and coaches as part of the ARPA money that they're getting from the federal government because it is allowed to support staffing stability and having mentoring and coaching is actually a way to support staffing stability.

[01:30:01] - Dr. Robertson. - Very quickly, I'll say thank you too. That was a very effective presentation and very helpful. I was struck by slides 28 and 34, particularly 28 being the illustration of how the U.S. stacks up with the rest of the world with that sample of countries in terms of time for collaboration.

[01:30:27] Thank you for sharing that with us. It certainly challenges us. Slide 34, I really appreciated how you reminded us that quality PD is not a one-shot deal and how sustained work in a collaborative manner is going to be most effective over time.

[01:30:50] And I really appreciate how you've placed emphasis on the National Board Certified Teachers Program. I don't know the extent to which the entire board has been made familiar with the program. I know that some of us around the table have worked with it closely over the years.

[01:31:10] It might be worth our time for us all to get somewhat of a primer in the national board certified teachers program um vcu has been into it for over uh two decades and i would i would uh posit to say that the um in the richmond area perhaps we have the greatest percentage of nbct teachers on a per capita basis you know among the school districts because of how it's been a point of emphasis it would be good too for us to um to to learn what the state's history has been with this.

[01:31:49] Some school systems have over time found that incentivizing teachers to participate in the program is real important in order to generate the enthusiasm, obviously, and also to contribute to this a rising tide lifts all ships notion within school systems.

[01:32:10] And some school systems then have added to the base salary of teachers a healthy stipend because they made their way through this opportunity successfully. The state, I believe, may have matched that at one point and then may have pulled back from that in tough times.

[01:32:31] So it's good to know that the state has recognized that this is a valuable professional development experience. It might be time for us to revisit that from the perspective of the state. Thank you. - Yeah, I've got, I guess, one question. - Yeah, I know. - Go ahead.

[01:32:48] - I just wanted to add one thing, which is I don't think I mentioned this, but not only more effective teachers, but more effective mentors than beginning teachers. So they can help be an engine in the system. - And I was gonna say, it's an easy way to find those folks to be mentors, because if you're bored to the side, you can start with those.

[01:33:09] And then of course there's other accomplished teachers, but it's an easy marker to know that they have that knowledge skills and positions in the classroom able to then have the training and mentoring as well.

[01:33:26] If you had to pick one of the states, which one would you model after? Who's doing this best? You know different states have different pieces of this and at moments in time some states have had lots of

the pieces and then sometimes the politics change and the next administration starts to take out some of the pieces that were there too.

[01:33:51] - And so I've written about the work that Connecticut did. They had a omnibus still back in the late 80s and then throughout the 90s, they put in place just about every element of good practice that we've been talking about. North Carolina did something very similar, which lived on until the early 2000s.

[01:34:13] And they still have many of the features there. They have so many of the policies there. Massachusetts has done some good work and I would say California is becoming a good model because we've been working hard at these different elements. And that's doing specific things well, so I'm happy to be a resource as you think about where you wanna go to help you connect to people in the states that are doing the specific things that you wanna work on.

[01:34:43] - Yes, you know, I'm on this board, I think I'm the businessman, if you will. I don't have the educator background, so you'll forgive this question. if it's so clear that this is right, that is that this is the right direction, how come more people aren't doing it?

[01:35:00] In other words, I think, you know, we as a board sort of state our goals as we want to improve student outcomes. And this, by the way, is not a challenge to your work, which, you know, makes clear sense and I believe is right. What I don't understand is, you know, what is, I mean, is it just theoretically right and near impossible to put into practice because of the, I'm serious about this because, you know, we don't pay enough, for example.

[01:35:29] We can't attract the people you need in order to make this system work the way you want it to work. I mean, what are the impediments here to, like I said, I believe everybody, regardless of party, you know, if you ask what the purpose of the school system is, it's to do the best for our kids, right?

[01:35:47] That's what we're all here for. And if we had a clear right answer, you know, in my world, we talk about this with poverty. You know, if there were a clear right answer to cure poverty, we think it would be done. You know, it's a harder problem than to just say we're going to institute these things. What do we do here to, you know, what are the drags on this that cause it not to be implemented?

[01:36:10] And, you know, how do we overcome that? My second daughter has a California teaching license. I think she still has it. She taught for a couple of years in the San Diego area in a fairly poor school. And she got her master's from, you know, University of Southern Cal and, you know, had decent training, did all the stuff.

[01:36:31] You know, two years in, she said, I'm getting absolutely no support. I'm in a poor jurisdiction. And so even here, you still have the have have not problem, right, where the better or the perceived to be better or, you know, wealthier jurisdictions perhaps put more levels of support around their people, more experienced people gravitate toward it.

[01:36:51] I mean, how do we get this from the theory into the practice so that overall, I mean, and our goal is to raise every child, not just the mean, right? Not just the upper group to raise the mean performance levels. How do we get there from here?

[01:37:07] And what's stopping us? Yeah. Yeah. That's a great, a really great question. And you said, how do we get from theory to action? I think part of it is having a theory of action that places teacher competence and principal competence you know at the center of the investments and the policy um in

business you said you're a businessman i think typically there's a great appreciation for the development of personnel and most businesses you know certainly substantial ones put a lot of resource into how do we develop

[01:37:41] you know confidence and um uh so that's important in in that context and when connecticut did its big reforms you know they they adopted a theory of action that the way we're going to get a stronger achievement is by investing in the knowledge and skills of teachers and principals who are gonna do it in all these ways.

[01:38:00] And it worked, and it has worked in, same thing happened in North Carolina, where Governor Hunt, you know, had started out to be a teacher. His mother was a teacher, he was committed to it. He said it was hard to become a teacher, decided to become a lawyer, it was easier that way.

[01:38:16] But he really had a commitment to that theory of action. Typically in education though, we have not had that theory of action. We've often thought that teachers are widgets, hire whoever you can hire off the street, who babysit the children for the lowest possible wage.

[01:38:35] And we haven't thought about the fact that you really need a lot of skill to do the job that we want teachers now to do. So the treating teachers like widgets has meant that we've put a lot more energy into other things like getting a teacher-proof curriculum or getting a, you know, whatever, a testing system.

[01:38:56] We spend a lot of money on testing children because there was a theory of action that if we would test the kids, then that would try teaching the right direction. But teachers can't do what they don't know how to do. And so, you know, investing in learning is critical.

[01:39:12] So it is a theory of action. And then when you adopt that theory of action, it needs to be systemic as we've been talking about. And I think that that is doable. I've seen some states do it, made a big difference. We've seen the achievement gains.

[01:39:28] I mentioned North Carolina, they were 48th in the nation in mathematics when they started a process of investing in preparation and evaluation and assessment and compensation of teachers. And by tying those all together, you don't want to raise teacher salaries without also raising teacher knowledge and skills.

[01:39:48] You have to bring those ideas together if you want to get effectiveness at the other end. And you know, it was in a 10 years, they were way above the national average. It was the first Southern state to break the national average. Virginia is sometimes considered a Southern state and came a little later than that in math.

[01:40:10] And so it can be done, but they were dogged about it and they stayed on it. And they believed that that was the important way to do the other thing. - So I appreciate that. - And you know, it's a feminized occupation too. Quite often, you know, people in the olden days, there was explicit assumptions that women should earn less than men and da-da-da-da-da.

[01:40:31] And that actually drove the way the teaching profession evolved in the United States. I mean, we also, I guess, one of the things, you know, I read the chapter in your book, and you mentioned, I think, in Finland, one of the things they did was go to five years for the prep programs and, you know, change the competitiveness.

[01:40:49] you know read the book before on that so uh you know our trend seems to be to be going to less time and training teachers right to get people out and through uh and i'm wondering i know this is a little bit off topic you know your your sort of opinion on the trend to say you know we need more therefore we're going to produce them less expensively yeah i um i was sad when virginia gave up the five-year requirement uh virginia was kind of out front on that because it was really as you say it was like what Finland has done and that moved them from being one of the lower achieving

[01:41:27] countries to being one of the high achieving countries because they really did invest in high quality preparation um you know i think that you can still get a good preparation to teach in a four-year program and an undergraduate program if it's well designed and if you get a full year of clinical practice under the wing of an expert teacher in a setting that is designed to be a like like a teaching hospital, a place where you learn to teach.

[01:41:52] It's about how do you use the time well? But when people come in without preparation, the evidence is that they leave faster and do less well for children. And that often happens when we have alternative reps that don't require some people to have that training before they get there.

[01:42:14] I came into teaching that way myself and I can tell you how challenging and difficult it is. and it certainly contributed to my not staying as long as I would have liked to stay in. I think, you know, partly if you're gonna have less time, you've gotta use that time really well and make sure that people get the clinical practice as well as the coursework.

[01:42:37] - Thank you. Anybody else? I know we've used an hour and a half of your time, and I'm, anybody? - This isn't a question for her, but I am curious in the conversation we were having about the board certification matter, just what do we know about the current supply of board-certified teachers in the Commonwealth.

[01:42:56] I'd be curious about that, if there's a way to just understand that. If it's not being collected, I'm not calling for a data collection activity, but I just think it would be interesting to sort of understand that in the context of the remarks that have been made on that in particular.

[01:43:15] - Where is it, I'm sorry, to follow on, where and what divisions are they? Do they actually stay in the divisions for how long do they move around? All of those kinds of things. - Dr. Johnson's waiting to suggest she has. - No, I can't see Dr. Johnson behind the screen.

[01:43:31] So yes, hello. - Yeah, doctor's on the screen. There's a doctor coming to the podium, so. - That falls under teacher ed and licensure. - I couldn't see. - And so we support VCU, as you mentioned, Dr. Robertson, as well as a grant from the state for those that achieve that recognition.

[01:43:55] And so we, as well as their national organization PROVIDE INFORMATION ON THE AMOUNT, THE YEAR, DEMOGRAPHICS OF WHERE THOSE TEACHERS ARE. SO JUST THAT WOULD BE AN EASY REQUEST. OKAY. OH, AWESOME. THANK YOU.

[01:44:10] THANK YOU. AND IF YOU'RE DONE WITH US, WE WILL TAKE OUR FOND ADEU. YES, THANK YOU SO MUCH. THANK YOU. GREAT TO SPEND TIME WITH YOU. GOOD LUCK. CALL ON US ANY TIME. THANK YOU.

[01:44:26] OKAY. WE CAN EITHER GO ON WITH THIS OR LEARN HOW TO DO AMERICAN NINJA WARRIOR. YOUR CHOICE. It may be easier. All right. We want to do a quick break before we do the

discussion, or do you want to keep rolling? Well, we have another presentation. We do.

[01:44:56] So, yeah, let's talk. Maybe we'll debrief a little bit. Take a break and then come back. That'll work for me. Okay. You know, this is all part of the, you know, what do we do next? What are the board priorities and goals for, you know, 2022? You know, some of the things that make me happy, of course, is when people tell us we're in the right path. And, you know, some of the things we clearly heard, I think, were teacher mentorship, principal mentorship are critical components to the system, which, you know, after a couple years of study is where this board ended up and, you know, built into the prescribed standards of quality. Not yet approved

[01:45:34] by the legislature, but at least prescribed. So I feel like we've been going down a pretty good track, and we don't have to repeat that process there. Question is, though, what are we looking to do in 2022? One of the things we had talked about at length over the last year was the evaluation system. In particular, in those days, it was linking the evaluation system to professional development opportunities. Now, we are aware that the department is going through, you know, the process of revising the evaluation system. I'm not going to ask

[01:46:12] the new superintendent the details of where you are on that, because it would be too much to expect for, you know, day three or whatever this is. But it may be that we let that process play a little longer without the, you know, significant active participation of the board, or it may be the board's desire to, you know, be in that process more significantly. You know, that's sort of part of the discussion for today. And then what other areas of interest are there? And, you know, just cause, you know, throw out as conversation starters, you know, one of the things that

[01:46:48] is moving through the legislature and frankly this board has talked about before uh our you know is literacy in the commonwealth you know again very much linked to the board's desire to improve the quality of education for all of our children it may be we want to discuss and look at standards around that and then you know a topic that probably only i have got such a significant interest in uh but because i think it's here to stay and it's not clear to me it's being done as well as it could be uh you know should we have standards around virtual education and i know this is different

[01:47:26] from the providers but uh you know we don't really know yet what works in terms of synchronous asynchronous how it ought to look uh to the extent that we are going to continue to have in the commonwealth and you know maybe not in the same percentages we saw during you know the height of covid but there's clearly going to be a decent chunk of it perhaps we ought to be looking at standards and studying you know what does work what doesn't work you know are the ratios that we have now for teachers to students appropriate in that setting should they be different you know how much time ought to be synchronous at different grade levels all those kinds of things um i don't

[01:48:05] know if the board has any appetite for that but i throw that those things out as a way to at least begin this conversation and you know perhaps we can you know talk about things that are on your mind that you know we could focus on for 2022 i can't believe i'm saying 2022 time flies so i'll jump in i i just think every time we hear from dr darlingham and we all come away feeling smarter and it's just uh such a treat um um i think that we have gotten some things rolling on evaluation

[01:48:43] system but i don't think we've done what she said which was have a we don't even have a work plan to do an integrated approach to teacher evaluation principal evaluation professional development licensure and teacher prep programs we've got pieces in several of those but we don't have an integrated

approach. I would love it when the legislature gives our new superintendent a chance to catch her breath, which may be a couple of months from now, but in partnership

[01:49:22] with the department, if we could figure out a work plan for an integrated approach to those five, all of which are kind of in our control. We don't really need new legislation or financial resources to to do what is within our purview on those topics um that we might and and and we've got i mean we could ask abtel for instance to take leadership on the teacher prep programs in the licensure piece at least in terms of coming up with recommendations for us and then we could tackle the evaluation and professional development teacher and principal evaluation and professional

[01:50:01] and and so rather than just leaving it to the staff work on evaluation in isolation from all of those if we could as a board help work in concert with the department and the new superintendent and staff if that's of interest um and as i say you're you're right it's not it's even too it's unfair to ask the superintendent what are her priorities yet but if that was something we could all work on together if and i would see a way for the board to be engaged sooner rather than

[01:50:36] later on the value you know the what we've been shown on teacher evaluation involved us later in the process but i i hearing that it needs to be part of a system approach maybe should involve us earlier um before superintendent balo responds my largest concern is that in a vacuum the evaluation doesn't move the needle and the other components that seem to move the needle which are things we have asked for and not gotten uh like legitimate teacher mentorship programs and principal

[01:51:15] principal mentorship programs right real building leadership uh you know we have not seen funded and i am you know i would be delighted for the board to stay involved with the work the department is doing with regard to evaluation my understanding was a lot of that had been hired out opposed to being done in-house oh and so that would be i would chime in one of my solutions suggestions is that we think about whether we need to get external support for a more systems

[01:51:49] approach you know hiring somebody like this level of expertise that we've seen today to help advise us on the systems level and and uh whether she's available or whether other other leaders would be more available or more uh but get that level of expertise to come in and help us think systemically and i'm happy to do this and i just and think about to get to the end of the day and just have an evaluation system change right would not be a good event in my life and you mentioned the mentorship but even if we don't get new money for mentorships the uh you know we do have these

[01:52:27] professional development requirements that we have some control over people are going to classes to accrue credits for professional development to renew their licenses because they have to do it now every 10 years instead of every five years so so you know they're they're spending or wasting money on um existing professional development requirements we we could use those you know if we tackled the professional development our authority over professional development um connected to licensing and tied that into what we're doing on evaluation and and we can we do have say over for both principal evaluation and teacher evaluation,

[01:53:05] those pieces might be things that are within our purview that we could actually move the needle on. And that might be things we could all work well together on. - Superintendent, do you wanna jump in this fray? - No, I didn't mean to put you on the spot.

[01:53:21] More as a questioning, come back and tell us in two months what you think about. - Yeah, you know, I think that that call to action is a really good opportunity for me to learn what's aligned and what isn't aligned. my hunch is that in two months when we visit VDOE staff is going to be able to tell you that some of those pieces are already aligned and maybe it's a way of the the board thinking about how do we put a framework around that how do we how do we package that in a way that that it's delivered to schools as a system not as pieces of you know any evaluation or professional development

[01:54:01] to um to seek your your credentials um and and currently nationwide it feels very disconnected my hunch is that it is less disconnected and it will be less disconnected if we can if we can package it in such a way um the other thing that that i would just maybe add to the list is um is it and and we mentioned it earlier is is really having a heartfelt discussion about national board certification and other opportunities that teachers have to be leaders within their schools not just not just becoming administrators or principals but really having some different

[01:54:40] opportunities to make the organizational chart in a school if you will a little more dynamic so that there are teacher leaders and and there are some opportunities for promotions for teachers themselves um i know that those in relation in relation to everything from a school's climate uh to retention of teachers those are those are all really great ways to engage that um and and student achievement i think that if if we identify this is my hunch i don't know this for sure but

[01:55:14] if we identify um clusters or areas across the commonwealth where there are more nationally certified teachers or teachers that have leadership opportunities that will find that student achievement is also higher in those areas so i just think it would be really important for for this board to continue deliberating on what does a system look like not just an evaluation system but an aligned system that really moves moves a school or a division forward because

[01:55:49] these pieces have become part of a system so i hope that that's that's what you're looking for so i i'll concur um with ms baylow's observation that it is the system and so thinking about our work plan for 22 mr gecker president gecker is for me would not be uh being tunnel vision on developing a teacher evaluation but really broadening that view a little bit and maybe

[01:56:23] our work plan around that issue is about developing a framework for the system itself. So maybe that's where our work is for 2022. And I would encourage us, as Dr. Darling-Hammond talked about, I've forgotten what state it was, but developing a theory of action or adopting a theory of action and that becoming the driving force that we all double down on for whatever series of years it happens to be and there is a work plan multi-year you know decades and when she said she said it's been a decade or two decades i'm like wow because that's exactly what it's

[01:57:01] going to take but if we focus on that then we begin i think to see more traction built and and hopefully results and we're not you know kind of ping-ponging around to what it is we're focused on but think about it big picture and then narrowing in on the steps along the path would be my suggestion because i don't think that focusing on teacher eval right now makes sense in a vacuum it doesn't make sense to me yes ma'am i would support that and i also think the point

[01:57:36] that you make about the resources that it takes to get this right can't be overlooked i think that is the frustrating you know dynamic and systems such as these that there are enormous expectations placed at the feet of teachers administrators and there is insufficient resources to support it and i feel like

if there's going to be a call to action then it must be across time across administrations because when we don't do that we keep the spin the drag president gecker you said

[01:58:14] what is the drag on the system the drag on the system in my mind a lot of times is situated on people come people go priorities shift priorities change the reality is having good teachers well-trained teachers well-supported teachers before our children matters and we have got to have the courage to say we do the thinking about what it takes if we don't put the money to support

[01:58:46] it why are you expecting to see things be different for children i just i love the systems thinking I love the idea that we you know have to disabuse ourselves of magic bullets and thinking it's just get this one thing right and it's gonna change it it's not learning is dynamic we saw that in action in the video that was played before it you go into classrooms you see that but yet we can't get out of our way

[01:59:18] and allow for the kind of support that makes a dynamic learning process work be realized and so i i could support focusing on a system strategy as long as there's a shared understanding that it doesn't get teed up as now go do this and there's no money for it that is frustrating that is demoralizing that makes you say i need to be someplace else i don't have the

[01:59:51] tools i need to succeed here money out dr robertson i won't disagree with anything that's been said i'll just add more to our list i would i would hope that we would keep front and center a focus upon what we know about the research and how it speaks to quality early childhood education experiences and that the board will take an interest and demonstrate that interest

[02:00:28] publicly and and getting reports and updates on how we stand within the commonwealth similarly i hope that we'll we'll get reports on the leadership pipeline i really appreciate everything that we're talking about right now in terms of teacher evaluation linda darling hammond wanted to wanted us to be compelled as well to talk about principal evaluation i'm not talking about that here i'm talking about getting quality leaders in the seats and i hope that we will will continue

[02:01:05] to emphasize the need for having not only a healthy pipeline but a quality pipeline i also believe that we need to monitor what's happening across the street in general assembly obviously i know we will during the legislative session but to the extent that we can give a greater support of influence to or umph to what is happening with the discussion about school construction there appears to be a great alignment of the stars right now to

[02:01:43] to position the state in a way that it's a leader and helping funding helping fund construction and i hope that we will follow that and seize the opportunities that may be there for us to give leadership to that agenda thank you dr deron uh echo all my colleagues comments on the evaluation and the system approach but i want to double down that i believe it's very important that we as a board begin to focus in 2022 on the efforts being made around literacy it's a critical time and a juncture for us to finally have another systems approach of thinking around what we do in

[02:02:21] the commonwealth around evidence-based instruction for literacy we've not had that as a commonwealth we've seen pockets of that occurring there's some movement our superintendent spoke on a bill today that moved out a subcommittee to the full committee there's a lot of great effort being done but we if we're not connected to that because it's not just going to be as dr man said a silver bullet to have the legislation passed on one hand we're going to have to continue to provide support and it's actually

connected in somewhat to the last conversation right around what dr darling hammond said around having that instruction that curriculum in place we've seen um failure i

[02:02:57] believe on our on the commonwealth's part to really adopt instruction and interventions that are based in evidence and we've seen a failure and not providing the money and the resources for school divisions to help our students move forward we've invested a lot of money and other things quick bullets here and there that have not yielded results and our teachers are really struggling trying to help support students so literacy i believe needs to be a very important goal of this board that we focus on how there are several bills i'm looking right now online there's about three or four bills right now the general assembly they're all aligned as a systems approach

[02:03:34] And so I really encourage us to keep close to that and to provide the leadership at this level needed jointly with our state superintendent. I was with her and I having a side conversation earlier and it's an area of her background and expertise that she'll bring to our Commonwealth.

[02:03:50] And I think that together we can really make a difference in Virginia. - Yeah, Ms. Holton. - So just thinking what's within our board authority as opposed to other players, the English standards of learning, i'm just checking uh are in their seven-year cycle for adoption in 2024 so it may well be that our role that we can help infuse that process with the uh we have a role there align that with the work going on on the role in teacher prep programs i mean we're delegated teacher prep and

[02:04:29] licensure uh oh under the new uh oh i mean we're delegated that authority now yeah and so right we will be involved in that process right but as we rewrite the 2024 standard is right around the corner in the way this world works so we we've got history standards up this year math standards next year and literacy english the following year so although we we have much more direct control over this area through licensure and teacher prep oh you think that may be even more important than the well it may be more direct for us you know uh the locals really have more control over how

[02:05:04] it gets taught and you know we have you know i'm not sure the standards would change dramatically for the method of teaching okay as much as the licensure requirements and teacher prep programs would have to change in order to accommodate the what's what i understand to be proposed at the legislature the other thing just in venturing into the priorities conversation not just the the reacting to dr darling ham and i did want to reiterate what dr robertson pointed out about the early learning early childhood is of necessity on our agenda this year because

[02:05:39] the continuing rollout of the work that we've already begun in that area will be a i i hope a major focus of our efforts this year getting that right yeah i figure that's why we have dr man absolutely and and and jenna conway you know mostly tells us what to do and we mostly say yes ma'am but um that that that will be i think on our workload this year i hope yeah so what i'm hearing is absolutely nobody wants to tackle virtual which is okay with me i will lick my

[02:06:15] wounds and go home sadly but i will do it i don't want to yeah mr swan um thank you for wanting to attack virtual but right now there's just a lot of how to do and uncertainty with virtual and speaking from teaching virtually and hybrid and in person sometimes the teaching can be ineffective because you can be on the screen and only have two children because some students have

[02:06:52] to go with their parents to work or to the daycare and so that's ineffective in itself and so i think the adding the virtual piece in there will be an even more challenge for teachers it's the concept was mr

swan to figure out how we can do it well you know we the board approved what the consortium of southwest divisions to do a virtual academy essentially and yet we don't have standards of you know how that ought to be done you know what is effective for those kids we don't have good

[02:07:29] measurements there you know what's the best way to teach should we be in our prep programs uh teaching teachers a little bit differently if they're going to be teaching virtually is should there be a you know different certification of some sort uh because it's clearly a different feel right look and feel you know i'm not taught at the k-12 but i have taught at the uh you know university level i've done it in person and i've done it virtually and you know it's a big difference you know how do you get people to engage even at the graduate school level it's different and so the thought was to begin to look at standards around what makes, you know, how are kids going

[02:08:06] to do better, you know, in the virtual environment. And as I said, you know, this is not to talk about, you know, who's, you know, the desire to have in-person schooling, but if we approve a virtual academy in Southwest, we know it's here to stay, right? I mean, that's something we did just recently. And so, you know, it bothers me a lot that we, not that we approved it, but that as we move forward, we have not looked at whether the ratios we require for, you know, students to teachers, you know, is right, wrong, you know, in the range, not in the range. You know, we had a

[02:08:44] discussion about how much synchronous time versus asynchronous time, you know, whether that's right, wrong, or in the range, you know, it is still as a percentage of our kids relatively small, and therefore, you know, it might be, you know, left for another day, but I don't want it to be lost side of because I think as we move forward, you will see more and more of it in teaching and modules.

[02:09:09] And you know, some of it prerecorded lectures, you know, maybe inverted classroom type stuff, you just don't know. But I do think it's worthy of the board study, but I also think that if we're gonna undertake the large systems review, that will crowd out our ability to do my relatively small topic, that's near and dear to my heart.

[02:09:34] I would just say I would be interested more so in just understanding what the state of the art is. I feel like, at a minimum, having an appreciation for what research we have on understanding, especially with young children.

[02:09:50] I mean, this is not an offering that's just being made available, you know, to older students. We're talking about, you know, K-forward. And I do think developmentally, what we know about young children and how they best learn at that age and stage of life, it would be interesting to understand what the state of the knowledge is regarding this kind of modality for education, for the benefit of the board being educated such that what we learn might introduce a need to sort of reevaluate our

[02:10:27] efforts in determining where this should be on a priority basis. I think that piece for me is like an open question, and I'd love to have a sense of what we know from a research perspective. UVA has produced some research in this area, and I'm sure that that's accessible to us.

[02:10:48] So am I not right that we figured out last year that we were, I think, many years overdue in addressing virtual learning regulatory requirements and we issued an aura on it.

[02:11:04] - We did. - So we have at least in theory started the process of having staff begin to gather information. I mean, in other words, we're 10 years overdue and we did something to at least begin the process moving last year.

[02:11:21] So won't that come back to us in some degree, how aggressively we, how assertively we push for it versus wait for it to come back to us in the normal course. But doing nothing is not likely to happen.

[02:11:38] - Okay, I got that message loud and clear. - Mr. President. - Yes. - Thank you. Great conversation and really nothing to add or counter, except that there is a sense of urgency, not through authority or a pandemic or anything else, but out of necessity for some and option for others, virtual education is not accessible and high quality all the time.

[02:12:14] And that should be our goal. It should be a viable option for any student who either out of need or choice wants to take part in virtual education. And the best way maybe over the next year to think about that.

[02:12:33] And I'm not advocating because I don't even know enough about the workings of this board and do we have too many priorities or not enough to do so. But it sounds like UVA has some statistics and some data on this. Again, my hunch is based on the great work that I've seen in the VDOE so far, there are some data within VDOE regarding virtual education.

[02:12:57] and maybe at some point, just to have a conversation about the data, make it very transparent, bring it into the open air so that we know what we're dealing with. You know, I think at this point, we're having a great conversation about virtual education, but none of us really is able to articulate, and this is what's happening across the Commonwealth.

[02:13:19] And so hopefully, if this does find its way onto a priority list, it's at least to acknowledge the sense of urgency around making sure that access to virtual education is always a quality experience okay so what i hear us doing as a board is we will undertake sort of the systems review approach uh teacher evaluation etc but with the goal of not doing teacher evaluation in the vacuum and basically telling people you know we're now going to evaluate you but we've done nothing else

[02:13:54] for you, right? You know, I will say some of the pushback I've heard from teachers I deal with has been, you know, you want to evaluate us, but, you know, you're really not giving us the tools at the local level we need in order to make this meaningful. You know, the PD is not high enough quality. You know, you're doing something again to us. And as you know, when we started this process, the goal was to do something for, not to, because to me, it's in conjunction with the other things the board you know putting the prescribed standards of quality uh you know dr wilson and you know superintendent baylow and i will get together and try to map out you know with the

[02:14:31] department a plan for how we approach the system's look at evaluation and other things brought up by dr darling hammond we will also coordinate on the literacy piece which is you know i think you know Dr. Duran said, you know, it's needed, it's going to happen, and it is right in the heart of this board's work, right? It's exactly what we want to be doing. And then, you know, if there's a free spare moments that Ms. Bailow doesn't mind spending, I'll talk to her about virtual alone.

[02:15:04] And that's how we can move in. We'll make it all transparent someday. Does that work? Uh-oh, maybe not. Well, I think that's great, but also recognizing that we've got a brand new partner who just walked in the door with Ms. Baylow that we should invite her input so that we can help align our priorities with her priorities to the maximum extent possible.

[02:15:30] And that would be an occasion, a more productive conversation in March. So I'm agreeing with your list, but suggesting that we also revisit this conversation again in March to the extent it would be

helpful to have her, The department's priorities don't have to be the same as our priorities, but there may well be things where it helps to have them aligned and overlap.

[02:15:55] You know, it has been our philosophy that the more we align with the governor's priorities, the more we will get done. So that, you know, that's been through the years. And so we will certainly attempt to coordinate on that.

[02:16:12] It's a generous assumption to think I will have priorities by March. Touche. I'm getting so much older, though. We've got to do it soon. Okay. Does that cover that topic well enough? All right.

[02:16:28] Thank you all. We're going to take a 10-minute break. We'll be back at, you know,

[02:16:32] just before 3:15, and we'll finish up in session. Mr. Bolling,

[02:26:55] welcome. Happy New Year. Happy New Year to you as well. President Gecker, Dr. Wilson, Superintendent Bailo, thank you so much for having me today to bring you an update on the high-quality and structural materials a process identification process that we are shifting from at the department of ed before i do start that i'd like to first of all thank dr amy griffin former superintendent of cumberland county public schools that has been a consultant all along the way doing uh yeoman's portion of the work and like to thank her for that i'd also like to thank the members

[02:27:35] of the board that were able to join us just recently for public hearings on the data science standards of learning so thank you all very much for being there as well uh with that uh so for many years uh the department of i mean the board of education has had the authority to approve textbooks it is in the virginia constitution it is also in the code of virginia as well in the standards of accreditation and it defines and and i'm going to move through i have a number of slides but i'll be moving them through them uh somewhat quickly if you would like you know me to dig in

[02:28:11] on something please let me know um and and so basically the process as has existed for many years and it was a print-based process that was focused on the approval of textbooks now textbooks as in the code of virginia is defined as it means print or electronic media for this for student use that serve as the primary curriculum basis for a grade level subject or course and as you all know there's been a lot of technological changes throughout the years and so the focus on actual

[02:28:51] textbooks and physical textbooks has really shifted to electronically based instructional materials some that are provided through companies like that and some that are made locally you know by either teachers and shared locally but also by organizations and others we will be focusing in on this shifting the process from textbook approval to identification of high quality instructional materials to be used by school divisions, well, selected by school divisions, and then utilized by teachers for students.

[02:29:29] Just as a little bit of background, just to make sure everybody's aware, we do develop standards of learning and curriculum frameworks, and those drive what is taught in classrooms in Virginia. Then school divisions develop their local curriculum that is based upon our curriculum framework and standards.

[02:29:51] And following the approval of standards, usually typically the year after, Virginia does do a textbook adoption process in that area. So for instance, Ms. Hulton, you were talking about English standards being revised in 2024 starting the process then they would be approved likely in 2026 I'm sorry

2025 sorry actually it's it's so they would begin the process in 23 and then approved in 24 and then the year following approval is when we had done the

[02:30:31] textbook approval process then the local school divisions have had the ability to either select from the approved textbooks that were provided by the Department of Education and through the Board of Education's approval process or they could run a similar process locally to approve textbooks so having said all that and giving you that background we'll jump in and talk a little bit more why the shift and I and I alluded to it earlier is that there's been this shift of teachers moving to more away from print resources to more online resources

[02:31:07] and and you I'll be talking in a minute about surveys that we did with teachers to get some information about that about what they were looking for and what they found to be important and but at the same time we also found that school divisions were shifting their their textbook allocations and moving it towards electronic media and so we thought that the last time that this process was updated was in 2011 and much has happened in the world since then and that was actually that revision process was spurned by an issue with one

[02:31:46] publisher for those of you that were around at that time and and there was a problem with a publisher and so we revisited the process at that time and updated it and I think it's now time that we move to the next level in Virginia and start identification of high-quality instructional materials from which school divisions can select so we started with finding out what other states were doing and some of the states that we visited and spoke with and their Department of Education staff was in Maryland and Massachusetts Nebraska

[02:32:25] Louisiana and others and we talked to them about their their process they had an approval process for high quality instructional materials versus a textbook approval process we talked to them about their identification process and their review process and then any other services or supports that they provided to school divisions in the implementation of those materials in addition we also communicated with ed reports because ed reports is a national leader in reviewing materials although they do only review materials in mathematics and language arts at this time and uh because we even talked about the possible we we looked at all

[02:33:05] possible ways could we even use their vetting process to pre-vet materials and and so we considered lots of different options but we wanted to be able to prove materials in more than just language arts and mathematics and so we wanted to have a consistent process for that so in october of 2020 we brought to you a um a written report about the the move to high quality instructional materials and established somewhat of a timeline to get started and from that time from october

[02:33:38] this is where we started so in december we started surveying teachers and we received over 870 responses i believe and that gathered information about materials that they're currently using what they thought would be important to include in the review criteria and rubric and also we had stakeholder meetings during april may and september as well as content work groups with internal staff we had meetings with publishers as well to talk to them about the process on their side and what is difficult for them or what could be improved on on our side as well as

[02:34:20] just looking at the practices that we currently have in place so here's a list of some of the stakeholders that we included and that was teachers uh a great deal of teachers curriculum leaders and principals groups as well as directors of special education cte we had our office of equity involved as well

as as well as superintendents um from different regions and we had uh mr swan join us on that stakeholder group as well as uh vascd vasco and also the commonwealth learning

[02:34:58] partnership so we had a great deal of stakeholder meetings and at those meetings we focused in on a couple of things first of all what are the criteria to identify what makes a high quality instructional material a high quality instructional material so the criteria and then once we had the the criteria identified we then moved to well what are then the indicators that should be identified to um that leads to the criteria being evaluated and so we were able to nail down those through this these summer work groups um i'm sorry uh through through those stakeholder meetings and

[02:35:37] then we led led into taking those to our content area specialists and developing their own rubrics for instance in mathematics or in english language arts etc that align to the overall rubric because we know that when you're evaluating materials you don't look at materials from different content areas in exactly the same way there are nuances and differences and so we did allow them to use a framework but also to allow some difference between the two and then we had a publishers

[02:36:15] meeting as and you can see some of the representatives that were included which was you know you well you i don't need to read them to you um but we just got a lot of their feedback and they were really excited first of all that that we asked them and then and then they provided a lot of good feedback about the medium and and uh for instance how things are submitted and how communication is is is uh flows between the department and between the publishers on feedback on you know what met criteria and what did not meet criteria in that feedback process

[02:36:53] and one of the things that they said resoundingly is it's a 100 paper process and we would like for it to be electronic and and we absolutely understand that and it's time to modernize our process now and so we do have plans to do so as well so the framework itself the criteria fell into four content uh four areas uh first were alignment to the standards of learning which has always been a criterion then alignment to the profile of a virginia graduate uh the five

[02:37:28] c's and so we felt uh all of the stakeholder groups felt very uh secure on those that those were two that absolutely needed to be there as well as the third and fourth that talk about instructional design and then the student experience and so we'll dive in so those are the four criteria and now we're going to dive into the indicators for each one of those so we do have a format it looks like this and it it basically provides the criteria the indicators

[02:38:02] the rating and then comments from the reviewers and as well as the rating system being a one through three either does not meet partially meets or meets expectations and we'll talk about what might be considered by the board for approval here in just a minute when in terms of how many twos or threes or you know things of that nature so diving into the performance criteria with the indicators the first one is pretty simple it's the publishers would then submit a a an alignment that they feel is right and then we have our reviewers check that alignment and verify it

[02:38:41] and then for the profile of a graduate it would be those supports uh evidence of support of development of critical thinking creative thinking communication collaboration and citizenship as well as how do we how what are the experiences that we're providing to make sure that we are preparing them for life and careers in the instructional design area you can see the list is a little bit more extensive it dives on in and it talks about uh the logical progressions

[02:39:14] of content the explanations of subject matter and clarity representing diverse experiences and perspectives of students evidence-based teaching and learning practices connections within and between disciplines and authentic applications and then supports for teachers in terms of differentiation of instruction and planning and instructional delivery i'll dive

[02:39:46] But just a bit deeper into a mathematics version, this is an example of how our coordinator in mathematics took the first indicator about the logical progressions and then provided some additional level of review.

[02:40:05] Those types of the blue lettering would be used in order to help train their reviewers to make sure that they're being consistent in their reviews and that they're looking at the same components for each material reviewed then the next criteria area would would be in the student experience and so the indicators in that area are supporting accessibility for students student supporting student agency supporting information processing as well as student

[02:40:41] engagement through relevant learning experiences so on the next few sides we have um so what we've done so far is is develop a criteria then we move to the actual process itself and we have a document that you you can read now the current process is is linked here and this chart compares the current process to the proposed changes that we're making to the document and it's our we're

[02:41:15] anticipating to bring a draft to you in march but wanted to give you kind of heads up and some background in it before we got to the march meeting so the current process just looked at alignment to the standards and instructional design and now we're adding those other areas the profile of a graduate as well as the student experience and we're expanding out on the instructional design to include things like evidence-based practices that it's built upon evidence-based practices uh in the past uh or in the current process it's the the um rating scale

[02:41:48] is adequate limited or no evidence and we're just changing that a bit we are going to propose that no material is identified as high quality instructional material that does not receive a meets expectations in all areas the current process does require a hard copy submission of everything including the assurances from the providers well as as well as information about the authors and we will be making that a digital or web-based

[02:42:26] program for not only for this for the publishers but also for the reviewers in the reviewing process I will tell you that one of my first personal experiences on serving on a Department of Education committee was many many years ago probably too many to count, but I served on a textbook review committee and I was living in a very small house in the city of Richmond and I got a shipment in of books that took up an entire room in my 1200 square foot house that my wife at

[02:43:01] the time was very unhappy with that stack and she said well let's get reviewing let's get them out of here you know and and so now instead of having this physical textbooks being shipped to every single household of every single reviewer and to the Department of Education everything will be made electronically available to the reviewers to administrators to parents to the whole community and the entire review process will be electronic and so that includes the final process which where we we publicly display materials we used to have sites throughout Virginia in libraries where we would lay

[02:43:39] all the materials out and people would come and view them and provide comment and that will all be a digital process now so we're really excited about uh the upgrade in in a in a doe process here

um next thing uh talking about is the review committee selection so uh the current process is nominations and uh also the selection to make sure that we have representation from across the state in large and so regional geographic regional and also uh size of school divisions to make sure that we have great representation of our reviewers we don't uh we're not proposing any change to that

[02:44:18] part um and then the process itself uh it will stay the same except for the fact that we'll have a new criteria new rubric and then we will have uh an electronically based uh process the publisher certifications and assurances are really an essential part of the textbook approval process as such for instance if something were to get approved and it's noted that there is a problem with it that none of the reviewers catch the certifications and assurances

[02:44:53] say that they will fix the error within a given number of days and so that's one that's an example and so we have a number of those in there and we ask them to assure us that the people that were writing this the textbooks were qualified uh as well as uh providing evidence of their uh evidence based um design and uh again we will keep that part of the uh the certifications and assurances uh the same uh we're proposing that um but is but it will be in a digital process Again, the publisher submissions will be digital

[02:45:32] Much of these will stay the same, but we're also going to allow them to provide a five-minute video that kind of orients the reviewers in How to like the layout of their materials and how it's all how all the pieces meet So the teachers edition students edition and then maybe ancillary materials that are being reviewed external the review cycle we we would imagine that it would stay the same and then school divisions could use our framework and identified

[02:46:07] Materials as high quality instructional materials for their local selection process again the public examination would be a digital process as well, so This just brings us back to the performance criteria and so I would like to encourage you all to think about a few things and number one is do you feel that the the criteria includes the things that you want and that you feel are important in identifying high-quality instructional materials as well as reflecting on this once we've identified high

[02:46:44] quality instructional materials and we have this framework that can be used for a number of things For instance, we have our go open Virginia, which is an open repository of educational resources now Some materials can be submitted by the Department of Education in that some can be submitted by teachers Some are you know if mr. Swan were to submit something I could take it in and Upgrade it for my needs and then republish it But it would be nice to have something you have a criteria in place that we could put a stamp of approval that says that it's a it's an approved Virginia high-quality instructional

[02:47:21] material that meets the standards of learning and it meets some of these other criteria and in that so we could take a version of it for materials that are non-primary instructional materials like not to hold textbook series what we're talking about is just individual pieces it might be a museum that wants to submit some materials to help teachers teach a topic well then we could review it in under the framework or a version of the framework that is catered to that particular product and then identify it as a high quality instructional material once again to take the time out for to reduce the

[02:48:00] amount of time teachers need to make sure that the standards are aligned to speed up the process for them because what we found in the teacher survey is they spend extraordinary amounts of time searching and googling and just trying to find the right lesson for their kids and it would really help the process if there was some sort of identification of a high-quality instruction material at the front that

they could say oh at least I know that the standards are aligned in it in it in it does you know meet the profile of a graduate and some of these instructional design pieces and then finally I wanted

[02:48:35] to bring to your all's attention one question and I'll I'm gonna skip here over to this screen is that I think one discussion that you all may want to have as a board or just think about prior to the March meeting is what would be the role of high quality instructional materials when it comes to divisions that require additional support through memorandums of understanding and would they need to select from our list because we have approved them as a board or is it something that you want to consider just keeping the process the

[02:49:12] same so I but I do think that that's something that should be at least discussed at some point and I would recommend it now going back to our final slides next steps here we will be seeking input from the parents and community as well as in March bringing it back to the Board of Education for first review in June renting final review and then the following spring and summer we'll build out our digital platform and then start implementing once we have the history

[02:49:46] and social science standards approved by the board then we can move to the textbook review or the high quality instructional materials review process for history would be the first one out of the gate so having said all of that i'm happy to answer questions and i may have to call on uh dr griffin to help me with some of the pieces but um would happy to entertain anything you have dr wilson then mr swan thank you very much um one observation uh and uh comments i think

[02:50:23] i heard you say that at the public examination point point of public examination that the materials would remain in a digital format exclusively that is the case as proposed proposed so one One observation would be in communities where access to broadband high speed is a challenge, do we inadvertently create a situation where people can't access, who may be interested, but won't be able to access the material?

[02:50:58] So that's an observation that I think we should probably think about. Absolutely. And then the second is your question to us about divisions that may be under a memorandum of understanding. My comment would be to what extent do we feel the need to remove that level of choice for divisions? So the process suggests that each of the four criteria are going to

[02:51:33] be met. It is certainly work for a division to go through. Well, no, I'm not certain. I'm not certain that I would feel the need to confine a division that happens to be under an MOU to have to choose from materials that the state has already identified if there is a good case to be made for why something else may be most useful in the context of their community.

[02:52:03] That's just my observation. I think that those are both wonderful points, and that's one of the reasons why I brought it to the board to just... Not just one member. no but to have a discussion about it but I because you're right I mean I multiple perspectives in terms of your first comment I do see taking the existing sites in turning turning them into some electronic viewing sites so the libraries that already have internet access for families where they can still come there view the materials just not in person and we would work with them those sites sites are identified across Virginia just one and then dr.

[02:52:41] thank you so much for the presentation um so you have stated that basically anyone can submit a high quality well a certain resource to be approved uh i believe the definition of it would be materials that are serving as the basis for a curriculum for a grade level or subject area okay so for this

process it would not be something from a museum uh it would that would typically be come from some of the major publishers yes sir so how long would that approval process take place before

[02:53:20] it is actually something that can be rolled out we would anticipate that it would take between 9 and 12 months to complete the entire review process so follow-up question as well when these materials are available will it be on the video page for teachers to use as well as can it be if that is the case can it be a simple process just speaking from experience going on the video

[02:53:52] e-page it is sometimes a hassle trying to find resources and so i'm just asking yeah right so the actual selection of instructional materials does happen at the local level and so and they are procured at the local level in the past what the uh through the this process what we've asked companies to do is identify the lowest or a I'm gonna miss I'm gonna mess these words up. It's it's a The highest amount that should be expected to be paid on a contract

[02:54:29] And Leslie is it might might be kind of scouring there when I when I said that But I believe that it's a negotiated price at the state level. So that is done at the state level So I'm sorry at the local level the selection is so therefore then it's made available to those teachers locally Not for the entire state we would publish a list of approved instructional materials dr. Robertson. Thank you, Michael great presentation

[02:55:01] I think we all know that in recent months. There's been certainly heightened sensitivity to the role that parents play in the in the selection of materials or the influence of curriculum and I know that we all want to demonstrate that parent involvement is indeed welcomed and incorporated and and influences the direction that we take on so many levels of our programming from the state to the local levels I'm pleased to see that February this next month just to be highlighted we are going to be seeking

[02:55:39] input from parents and the community on this this particular process and i recognize that this process deals primarily with what we would call the selection of textbooks or the or the basic materials as you describe them is there along the way still some emphasis placed on parents role in the selection of materials locally does the state stipulate what parents participation should be as part of the selection process once we push uh the options to the localities for their

[02:56:15] for their own decision making do we say anything about what role parents should have i don't believe in the current process that that is required of school divisions however having done textbook approval processes uh in multiple school divisions in virginia myself and led those we always had um a process that involved parents in uh along the way and input as well as the the viewing uh the ability to view review materials that's been my experience too it seems to me uh in order to make sure that we are open and transparent as much as we can with this particular

[02:56:52] process we would want to say something like that that absolutely that the state recommends that parents participate in these processes if if we're not going to require it even i think that's a great idea thank you dr duran just some clarification on the review committee you said that those are nominations of individuals that serve that are uh geographically i think you said represented across all small large school divisions what kind of training or rubrics or guiding language is provided to them for the rating of three to one that you described because there is some subjectivity that can be concerning in a couple of these um one that i want to raise

[02:57:31] is on the instructional design it says represents diverse experiences and perspectives with respect to student cultures and backgrounds and i've seen time and time again many review committees

not being themselves culturally diverse and having background of diversity amongst the members outside of yes i've always seen large school division small division northern southern central we've always had a great job done at that but i haven't seen the same job always done in terms of who is selected to look at this question of whether or not the material actually actually provides some perspective from populations of students who actually no one on the committee

[02:58:07] is even representing so that's concerning to me on one hand but if there's some training or language that helps us get to another place as we're entering history there's so many of our instructional materials that we see and at the local level that's why we do our own process sometimes and we find materials that are more representative so that's just little concern that i have i i think it's a great point and as soon as you brought it up it reminded me that i missed a very major bullet on this slide in front of you here is that if you'll see here that we developed not just the framework tools but then also descriptions of each one of these areas and so it does outline and

[02:58:44] provide deeper detail about what we mean by each one of these um uh the of the actual areas and the criteria and the indicators and so then the the actual training is is done through the content coordinator here at the department of education that assembles the team provides expectations walks through those descriptions document and i apologize for for not including that on here oh that's very helpful but i also just as one board member would hope and encourage as we go through that nomination process that we're very mindful of the instructional design question and how we are looking at ensuring that the right voices are either at the table or that the voices

[02:59:23] at the table are concerned about all student populations because there's a lot of high quality instructional materials that do not represent our students and they don't see themselves in some of the literature they read some of the history it's missing for them right and so then we as school divisions often have to supplement that with other things and in my mind if we're having to supplement something then it's not high quality because it's missing that key part and it's one of our areas here of our performance criteria so since it is one we need to make sure that that follows through to the actual approval process yeah thank you very much for that and uh that does when i did when i was talking about uh when we're selecting members of the uh content or the review committees

[03:00:03] uh we don't just look at regional and cult uh representation we also do look at race ethnicity um we look at gender as well uh in the composition of the committee to make sure that there's representation thank you dr man i'm sorry it's okay thank you so much um i had a just a couple of questions i was curious about uh the publishers and just to what extent because this is this is not textbook proper but i know these are like going to be considered in that realm as part of

[03:00:38] the approval process did you find that because we were shifting to high quality instructional materials that it introduced more opportunity for publishers who are perhaps not in the textbook business to be uh have an opportunity to make resources available through this channel we thought it would open up the doors um for anyone that has digital content that was made available and then it when it came down to the local level if they were looking for a physical textbook that would be a part of their selection process but it does make it a little bit more

[03:01:14] accessible for more publishers to submit their materials for consideration as the primary as i said that as the basis for the primary curriculum for a grade level or subject area okay and then with just two more questions because i guess as i pitch your digital content i i tend to see it visually and this may not

in fact reflect what you all are seeing but i'm curious more um isolated content as opposed to and i'm looking at the criteria that all of these materials would be

[03:01:50] judged against and it's it's a lot for and i'm wondering how are you seeing um resources that are a bit more comprehensive in their coverage of some of the content or is it more isolated concepts within a content area i'm just really curious about about how how resources in this space are being evolved to support learning i think that the evolution you know began obviously with physical textbooks right and then there was the teacher resource bank uh you know the box that came beside it uh and then maybe some um leveled readers and different uh different ancillary

[03:02:30] materials that are available then as as things started shifting there were electronic versions of student textbooks that was the next like evolutionary piece and they so they had the textbooks in the classrooms which were typically stacked along the wall and then they gave students a code to log in and and review or to be able to read and use materials at the same time i think that there was a shift away from using a textbook to drive instruction and really focusing in on what was essential to the understanding and concept concept building and the skills and

[03:03:05] processes that were necessary and so then i think you started to see a shift of saying well we have those materials available and we we stopped buying them physically but we do have them electronically and so i i feel like there has been this evolution towards just purely electronic resources in terms of evaluation those resources would be looked at holistically and not page by page or because it's hard to for instance when we're in the area of the criteria area of meeting the profile of a

[03:03:39] graduate not every lesson will necessarily meet every piece of the profile of a virginia graduate and so we have to look at holistically about the experiences overall that are provided in the material do they align with the profile of a virginia graduate for instance okay my last question is just on maybe you can unpack a little bit the definition of how evidence-based is evaluated in the context of the rating because that is a part of the instructional design and i'm just curious what kind of guidance is given as people are sort of sizing that up right um

[03:04:18] so we we had a lot of discussions about what evidence-based meant uh and um and so what we decided upon is that we would ask the company to provide evidence of what research in evidence-based practices instructional practices were used in the development and were the underpinnings of the material and that is included in our description right we'll have a section on that for publishers and so we will be bringing this to you you know for full review and we can certainly change that

[03:04:55] definition or descriptions as as necessary if you all see fit mm-hmm thank you mr. president and and I think maybe this is more of a discussion question then then a question that you might be able to answer today but as I'm just this is this is all brand new I've I've not worked in a state where the the State Board of Education or anyone at the state level was prescribing was prescribing textbooks or approving textbooks so that said i know it happens across across the

[03:05:29] nation but i can't help but kind of wonder about the purpose for this and and as i um before my my life my professional life was turned upside down that means over christmas vacation um i was i was reading an article i think it was in education week and there was um 66 of of teachers excuse me teachers use their own either created purchased or searched for curriculum 66 percent

[03:06:04] of the time so as we're talking about these other material that the board also has authority over with um with any school board may use textbooks not approved by the board provided the local board select such books in accordance with regulations promulgated by the state board so that said if we have 66 percent of the curricular content in classrooms and i i realize that that's not the commonwealth that's across the nation it was a very large teacher reported

[03:06:39] survey but um if that's the case then going back to that purpose what is what is our mechanism as a board to ensure that we are continuing to be aligned to the virginia standards of learning the profile of a graduate instructional design and student experience because my hunch is that not every 23 year old or even seasoned teacher who's spending seven hours a week searching for lesson plans or purchasing lesson plans is going to the going through the exercise of making sure

[03:07:19] it's aligned uh making sure that the instructional design is appropriate and that the student experience is um is appropriate and that that really drives to dr durand's point about um you know sort of just the the appropriateness of of state selected textbooks or or curriculum and textbooks i'm using loosely i realize that and so i guess just for discussion purposes it appears to me that at the community level or even at the school level some of those decisions are best

[03:07:52] made if we empower school districts to implement this framework this design for um assessing the rigor of high quality instructional materials so i lay that out there maybe more as a discussion kind of the new maybe the new kid on the block the new perspective and just really thinking about the why of all of this and making sure that if we're going to be talking to stakeholders if we're going through these exercises of approving textbooks and putting ourselves as a board and as a department of education out there as sort of approving or giving a stamp of approval

[03:08:28] that that that that that ought to be a process that applies to a hundred percent of the curriculum not um 44 of the curriculum right and then one more point if i if i uh could mr president is just around around transparency and I love that that is one opportunity that we have as a Commonwealth to be very transparent here are the approved textbooks but again thinking about what does that look like at the community level is it required at the community level to also post curricular materials

[03:09:04] like we do at the state level so again a discussion level or a discussion question just thinking about the why and a couple points to add in and i think you've made some really wonderful points um uh you know materials um you're right many many teachers do develop their own materials absolutely and they usually base it off of something that they have or have borrowed from a friend or gotten from seeing in a textbook um what we're hoping to do and and virginia has identified or or approved textbooks for a number of years and so um i think what this really the

[03:09:44] identification of high quality instructional materials kind of allows a teacher to say wow this this is something that's pre-vetted this is something i can just go ahead and use and it's been provided to me it's and it also uh the process also helps small school divisions that have a very small capacity when it comes to reviewing and approving materials they really do value the approval of the department to help them in their process and speed up their process locally and potentially save them time and money um so there are a number of things like that but yeah absolutely

[03:10:19] i want to take us back to the constitution um and into the code of virginia that the board has the authority it doesn't say that they shall and so that's certainly something that the board may choose to not exercise um and and that but that is that is i just wanted to point that out so it's it's not a requirement of

the board i'll say a couple years ago i don't know if you recall mr bowling we talked about not doing it because it is not mandatory and you know the comments that came back were that the smaller jurisdictions didn't have the same resources that the larger jurisdictions

[03:10:56] had and we were really acting as a larger resource for the you know less well-heeled divisions in the commonwealth and so we continued down this path at the same time i thought that we had had a discussion uh that we would actually like to move away from sort of textbooks or the schools were moving away and it's just suggested a lot a lot of material is teacher generated as opposed to textbook generated and i thought we were working toward a system of open educational

[03:11:29] resources that would, you know, provide for the materials needed for the locals to have curricula that were aligned with the standards, et cetera. And I know this doesn't quite hit that topic, but it sort of does, right? I mean, the idea that we ought to be taking a lot of time, you know, to do the textbook approval when it's now a fairly small portion of what happens in the school day to day may not be a great use of the resources as much as providing you know again the

[03:12:07] open educational resource data bank that we had talked about you know years ago that James had talked about you know quite a lot you know I guess we will as a board as long as the smaller jurisdictions needed to continue to approve textbooks right I mean that's part of the historic role I think that's what we're going to do and the process is great we don't approve the other materials. I will tell you, in a non-scientific sampling of those jurisdictions we have under a memorandum of understanding in those places where, you know, test scores are not as good as

[03:12:43] others, you know, the first thing we look for is alignment of the material to the standards, and that alignment often is not there. You know, we would do the Commonwealth a service if we would, in fact, be more diligent about ensuring, and I know we have the constitutional issue of the locals control the locals, but being able to force an alignment of the curriculum or of the material to the standards would be a very big thing for us long term.

[03:13:14] And I know in places like Arlington, you're not going to have this problem, right? You guys are aligned. But it surprises me when I go to those meetings, you know, with some of the MOU jurisdictions And, you know, you look at what they're using to teach X, Y, or Z, and it's just not a Virginia, you know, it's not aligned to our standards, and therefore you can't expect those kids to test well on the Virginia test.

[03:13:38] Ms. Holton. From my understanding, am I right, too, that one of the reasons that many local divisions appreciate us going through this process is if they are, well, that they are spending large sums of money on textbooks, and when they are spending large sums of money, they are required to go through public procurement processes which are cumbersome however they don't have to go through those processes if we have so to speak so when we approve textbooks they are then exempt from the same procurement processes if they buy off of our outside of our

[03:14:17] list then they've got to go through the procurement hoops that is which it costs time and that's we act as a service to a smaller jurisdiction absolutely really can't do it on their own absolutely it's not that we are mandating what's being used it's we're providing right this list of vetted and mr president your point about oe uh open educational resources is you know that now we're talking about getting people good quality stuff for free and that's certainly an ultimate goal it is and we have a tremendous amount of uh materials in our go open uh resources right now

[03:14:52] and it's growing um as i speak uh and and i think it would just sometimes it's nice when you go into an open resource database to know who developed the material and what their qualifications were and whether or not they were biased in there because that's the whole purpose of open educational resources right is to is to allow people to to blossom and do what they need for their kids and so i i personally believe that that that having a stamp that kind of says hey this has

[03:15:25] been vetted i think might be a benefit to many teachers uh also one more question am i right that whether regardless of what teachers are in fact using most school divisions are in fact still purchasing textbooks whether they're purchasing them in the hardbox version or the electronic version they are still spending a lot of money on these resources yes ma'am and part of that is connected to teacher shortages and number of provisional teachers and making sure that they have resources in place that those teachers can fall back on if they're not 100 confident

[03:16:03] in the content or the pedagogy associated with that content sometimes having something that has been vetted uh is nice to fall back upon and did i understand that you see this framework potentially is helping uh offer a lens even on the open source resources that live on the current website that that this can become a framework that helps people sort of look at those resources and make some judgments about them i understand you're not proposing to have those things vetted perhaps in

[03:16:38] the same way that you're suggesting this process would work to approve high quality instructional materials but it becomes a framework that could be useful 100 we envision this as the framework from which criteria can can be made to judge different types of instructional materials like i said an example of a teacher created material all the way to a museum created material or by a small company or group so i i we're excited about the possibilities of how this this could bleed into things like, for instance,

[03:17:16] the identification of a high quality micro-credential in the future. And so if we know that these components are important for content and pedagogy, then maybe that could also bleed into a criteria for micro-credentials, professional development, and some other areas.

[03:17:34] - For everything besides textbooks, the department could do that without the board. - Certainly. - And we have no authority, frankly, for anything besides textbooks. - Certainly. And so we will certainly do what the board wishes and the superintendent.

[03:17:51] And so I have provided the information. I hope that it's helpful to you and I'd be happy to take any other questions. - That's it. Thank you very much. - Okay, thank you.

[03:18:06] - Yep, okay. No concluding remarks other than we are adjourned until tomorrow morning at nine. - Thank you. - Thank you.